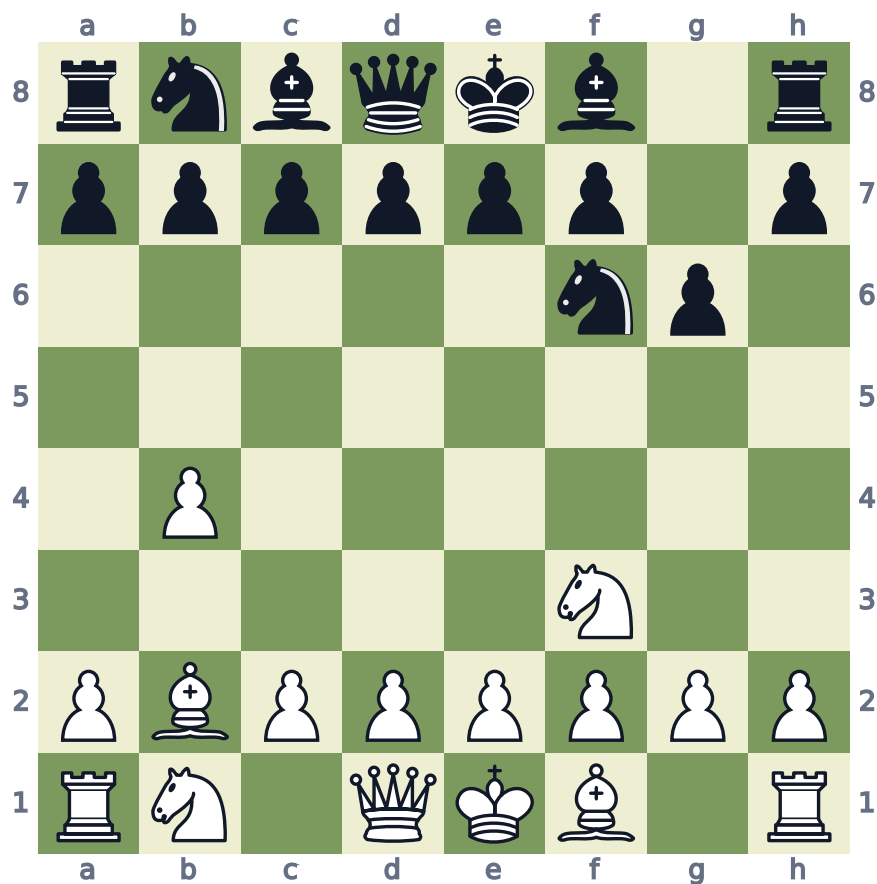


Hippo Final Workbook and Fritz Companion

Mixed tests, repertoire recall, PGN training, error repair, and a sixty-day schedule



Convert the fifteen volumes into a durable practical system through mixed retrieval, spaced review, and computer-assisted training.

60 learning units | solid-piece diagrams | recall tests | engine checks

ORIENTATION

How to study this volume

PURPOSE

Convert the fifteen volumes into a durable practical system through mixed retrieval, spaced review, and computer-assisted training.

THE HIPPO TRAINING LOOP

- First identify the center, both kings, and the opponent's most forcing pawn break.
- At every diagram, name the urgent threat and compare e5, c5, f5, and b5.
- Hide the answer until you have spoken the move, its purpose, and the opponent's best reply.
- Replay each branch from both sides in Fritz or another board program.
- Review misses after 1, 3, 7, 14, 30, and 60 days.
-

WHAT COMPLETE MEANS HERE

This volume contains 60 units inside a connected Black core repertoire. It teaches setup, exceptions, transformation, and resulting plans; the PGN companions make later updating possible.

STRATEGIC FOUNDATION

Principles 1-3

PRINCIPLE 1

Mixed positions test recognition instead of chapter memory.

PRINCIPLE 2

Recall the break and its purpose, not only the setup moves.

PRINCIPLE 3

Analyze your candidates before switching on an engine.

VERIFICATION QUESTION

What would have to be true for one of these principles to be wrong in the current position? Check forcing moves before applying a strategic rule.

STRATEGIC FOUNDATION

Principles 4-6

PRINCIPLE 4

Classify misses by cause: threat, move order, break timing, calculation, or structure.

PRINCIPLE 5

Update a personal PGN from your own games.

PRINCIPLE 6

Spaced retrieval turns a large library into usable over-the-board skill.

VERIFICATION QUESTION

What would have to be true for one of these principles to be wrong in the current position? Check forcing moves before applying a strategic rule.

FINAL-EXAM RULES

Test retrieval, not chapter recognition

RULE 1

Use a 10-minute clock for five positions at first; reduce the time only after accuracy is stable.

RULE 2

Name the defense before choosing the move.

RULE 3

Give the move, its purpose, the opponent's strongest reply, and the intended structure.

RULE 4

Mark confidence from 1 to 5 before revealing the answer.

RULE 5

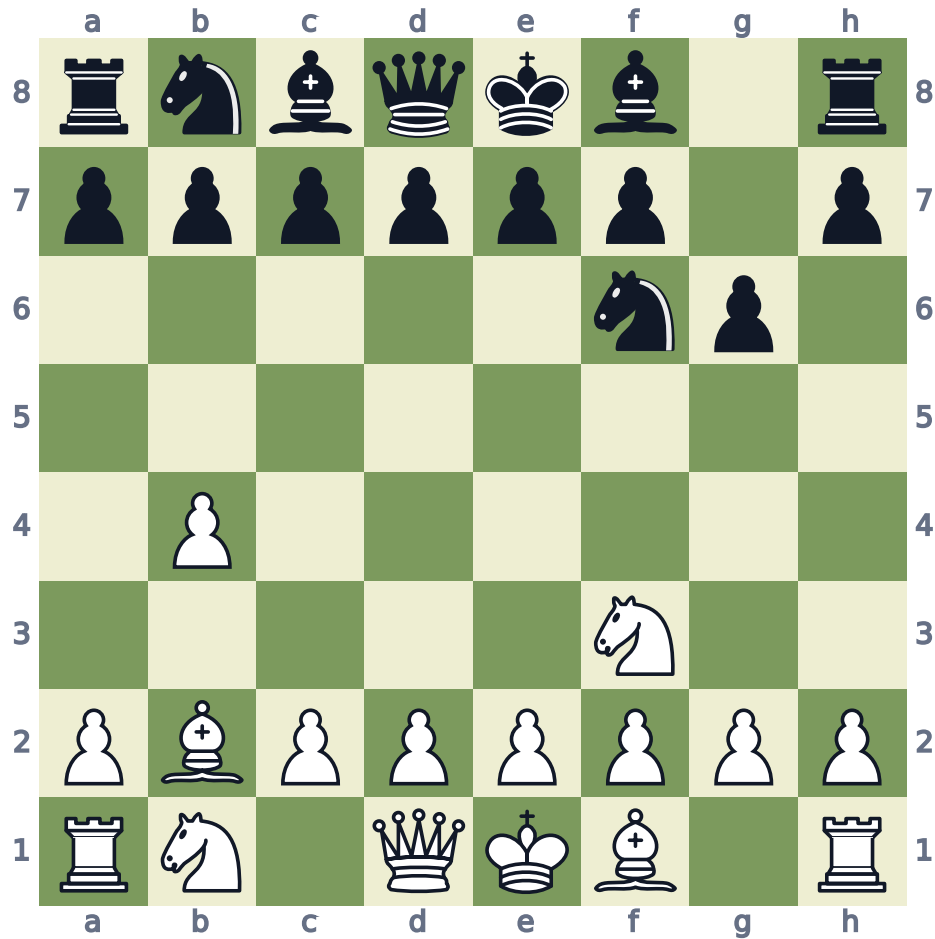
A confident wrong answer receives a priority review tag.

RULE 6

Score 80 percent twice, one week apart, before calling the repertoire learned.

MIXED TEST 01 OF 60

Identify, choose, explain



YOUR COMPLETE ANSWER

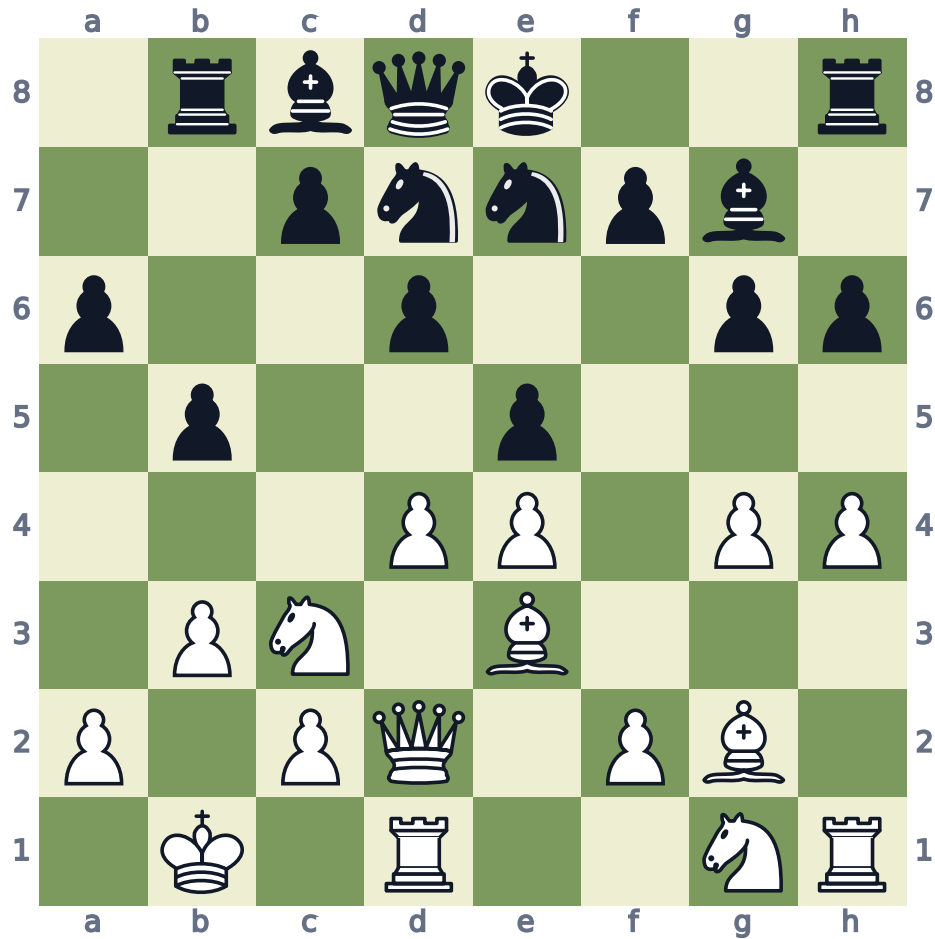
Black to move. Identify the setup and move-order clue. Choose the course move. Explain the purpose, the opponent's best practical reply, the likely pawn structure, and the tactical feature that must be checked before moving.

TEN-POINT SCORE

2 identification | 2 move | 2 purpose | 2 reply | 1 structure | 1 tactical check

MIXED TEST 02 OF 60

Identify, choose, explain



YOUR COMPLETE ANSWER

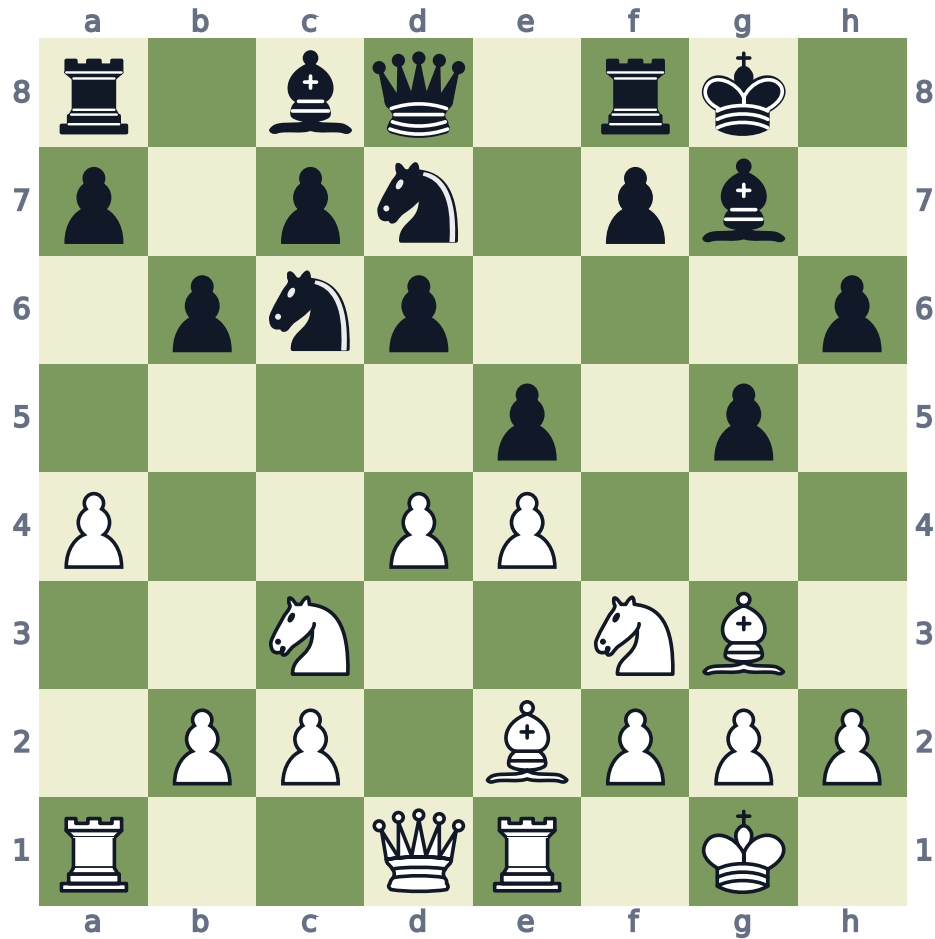
White to move. Identify the setup and move-order clue. Choose the course move. Explain the purpose, the opponent's best practical reply, the likely pawn structure, and the tactical feature that must be checked before moving.

TEN-POINT SCORE

2 identification | 2 move | 2 purpose | 2 reply | 1 structure | 1 tactical check

MIXED TEST 03 OF 60

Identify, choose, explain



YOUR COMPLETE ANSWER

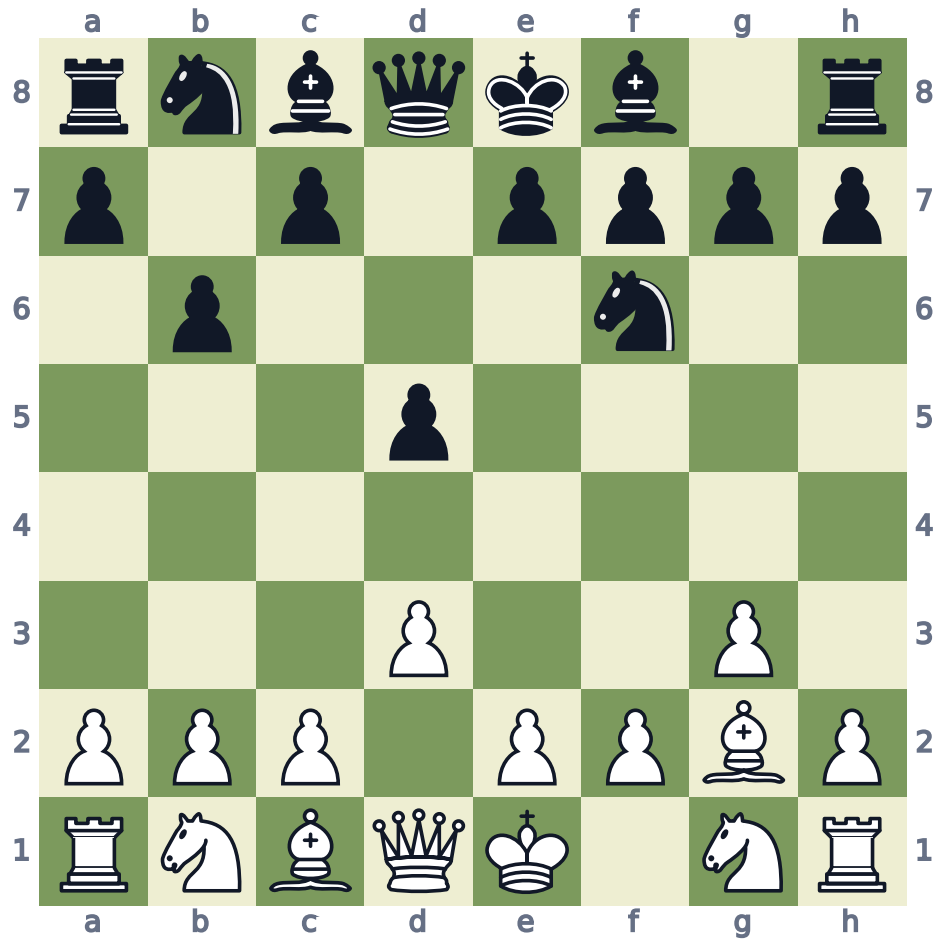
White to move. Identify the setup and move-order clue. Choose the course move. Explain the purpose, the opponent's best practical reply, the likely pawn structure, and the tactical feature that must be checked before moving.

TEN-POINT SCORE

2 identification | 2 move | 2 purpose | 2 reply | 1 structure | 1 tactical check

MIXED TEST 04 OF 60

Identify, choose, explain



YOUR COMPLETE ANSWER

White to move. Identify the setup and move-order clue. Choose the course move. Explain the purpose, the opponent's best practical reply, the likely pawn structure, and the tactical feature that must be checked before moving.

TEN-POINT SCORE

2 identification | 2 move | 2 purpose | 2 reply | 1 structure | 1 tactical check

MIXED TEST 05 OF 60

Identify, choose, explain



YOUR COMPLETE ANSWER

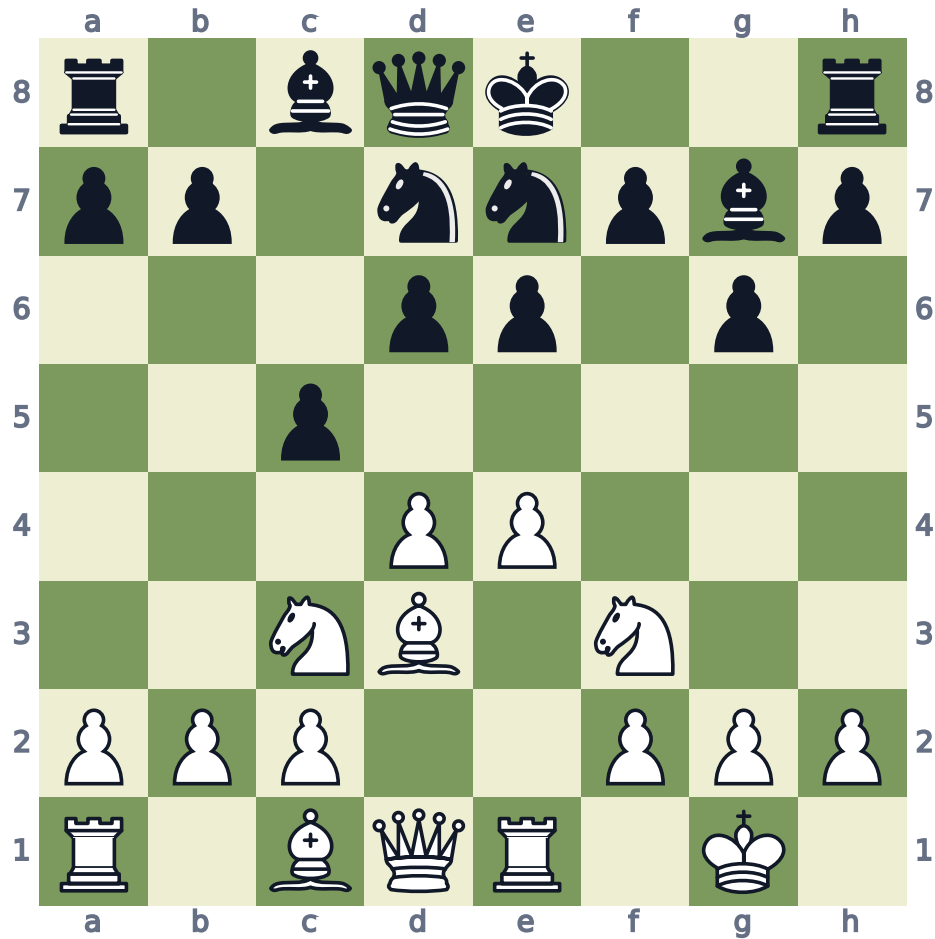
Black to move. Identify the setup and move-order clue. Choose the course move. Explain the purpose, the opponent's best practical reply, the likely pawn structure, and the tactical feature that must be checked before moving.

TEN-POINT SCORE

2 identification | 2 move | 2 purpose | 2 reply | 1 structure | 1 tactical check

MIXED TEST 06 OF 60

Identify, choose, explain



YOUR COMPLETE ANSWER

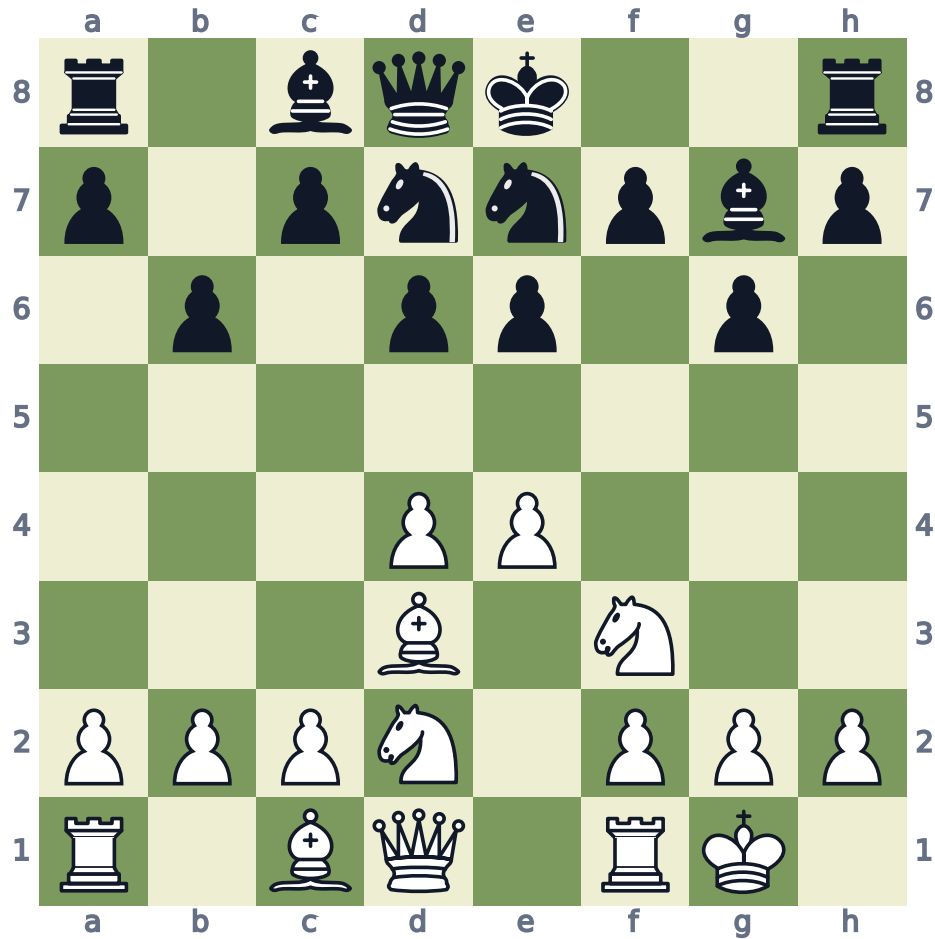
White to move. Identify the setup and move-order clue. Choose the course move. Explain the purpose, the opponent's best practical reply, the likely pawn structure, and the tactical feature that must be checked before moving.

TEN-POINT SCORE

2 identification | 2 move | 2 purpose | 2 reply | 1 structure | 1 tactical check

MIXED TEST 07 OF 60

Identify, choose, explain



YOUR COMPLETE ANSWER

White to move. Identify the setup and move-order clue. Choose the course move. Explain the purpose, the opponent's best practical reply, the likely pawn structure, and the tactical feature that must be checked before moving.

TEN-POINT SCORE

2 identification | 2 move | 2 purpose | 2 reply | 1 structure | 1 tactical check

MIXED TEST 08 OF 60

Identify, choose, explain



YOUR COMPLETE ANSWER

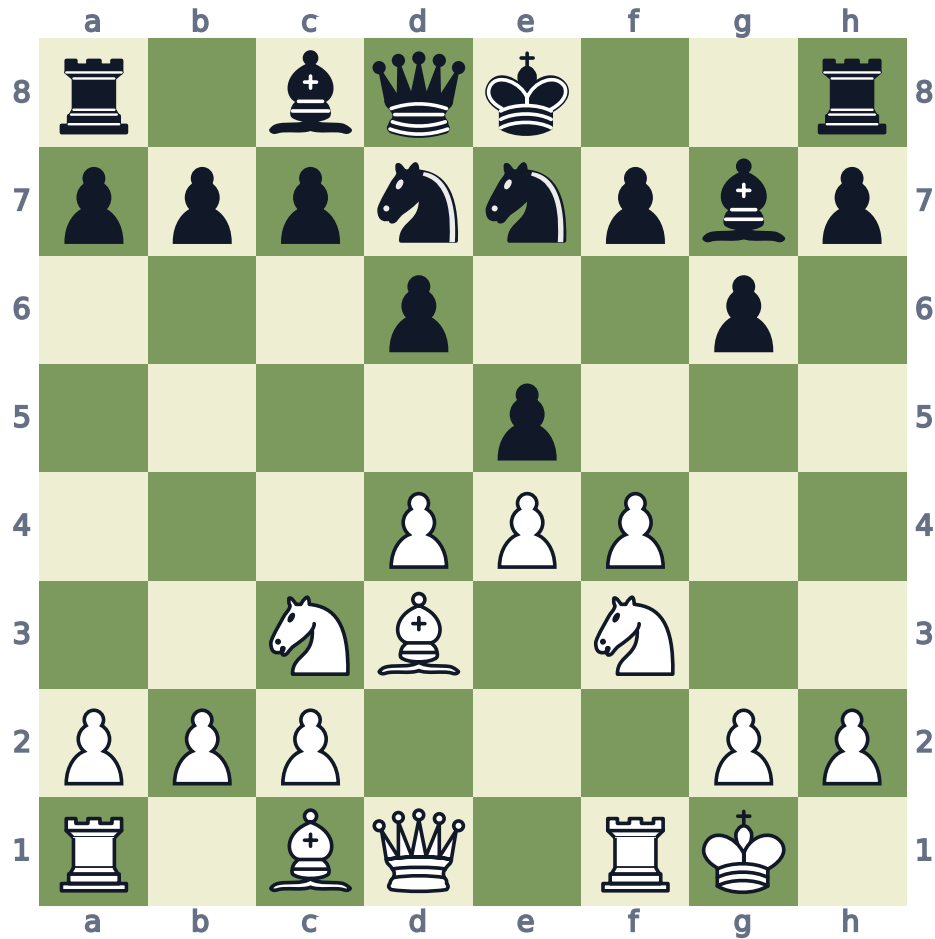
Black to move. Identify the setup and move-order clue. Choose the course move. Explain the purpose, the opponent's best practical reply, the likely pawn structure, and the tactical feature that must be checked before moving.

TEN-POINT SCORE

2 identification | 2 move | 2 purpose | 2 reply | 1 structure | 1 tactical check

MIXED TEST 09 OF 60

Identify, choose, explain



YOUR COMPLETE ANSWER

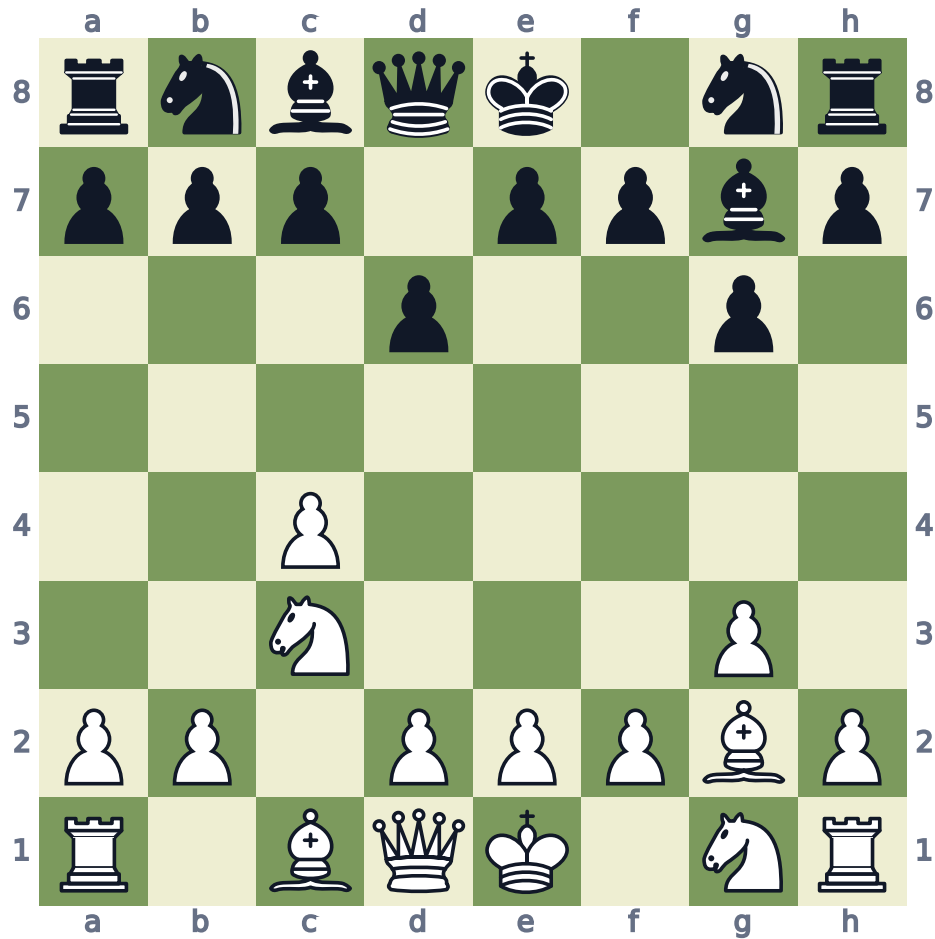
White to move. Identify the setup and move-order clue. Choose the course move. Explain the purpose, the opponent's best practical reply, the likely pawn structure, and the tactical feature that must be checked before moving.

TEN-POINT SCORE

2 identification | 2 move | 2 purpose | 2 reply | 1 structure | 1 tactical check

MIXED TEST 10 OF 60

Identify, choose, explain



YOUR COMPLETE ANSWER

Black to move. Identify the setup and move-order clue. Choose the course move. Explain the purpose, the opponent's best practical reply, the likely pawn structure, and the tactical feature that must be checked before moving.

TEN-POINT SCORE

2 identification | 2 move | 2 purpose | 2 reply | 1 structure | 1 tactical check

MIXED TEST 11 OF 60

Identify, choose, explain



YOUR COMPLETE ANSWER

Black to move. Identify the setup and move-order clue. Choose the course move. Explain the purpose, the opponent's best practical reply, the likely pawn structure, and the tactical feature that must be checked before moving.

TEN-POINT SCORE

2 identification | 2 move | 2 purpose | 2 reply | 1 structure | 1 tactical check

MIXED TEST 12 OF 60

Identify, choose, explain



YOUR COMPLETE ANSWER

Black to move. Identify the setup and move-order clue. Choose the course move. Explain the purpose, the opponent's best practical reply, the likely pawn structure, and the tactical feature that must be checked before moving.

TEN-POINT SCORE

2 identification | 2 move | 2 purpose | 2 reply | 1 structure | 1 tactical check

MIXED TEST 13 OF 60

Identify, choose, explain



YOUR COMPLETE ANSWER

Black to move. Identify the setup and move-order clue. Choose the course move. Explain the purpose, the opponent's best practical reply, the likely pawn structure, and the tactical feature that must be checked before moving.

TEN-POINT SCORE

2 identification | 2 move | 2 purpose | 2 reply | 1 structure | 1 tactical check

MIXED TEST 14 OF 60

Identify, choose, explain



YOUR COMPLETE ANSWER

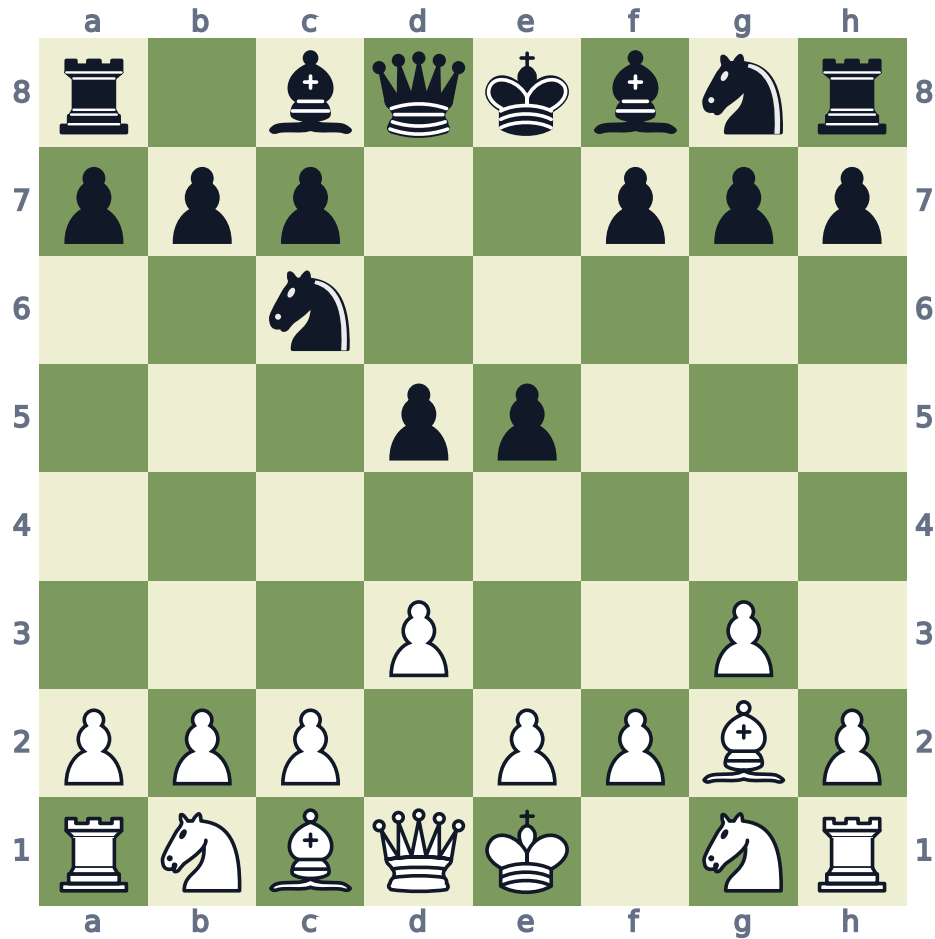
Black to move. Identify the setup and move-order clue. Choose the course move. Explain the purpose, the opponent's best practical reply, the likely pawn structure, and the tactical feature that must be checked before moving.

TEN-POINT SCORE

2 identification | 2 move | 2 purpose | 2 reply | 1 structure | 1 tactical check

MIXED TEST 15 OF 60

Identify, choose, explain



YOUR COMPLETE ANSWER

White to move. Identify the setup and move-order clue. Choose the course move. Explain the purpose, the opponent's best practical reply, the likely pawn structure, and the tactical feature that must be checked before moving.

TEN-POINT SCORE

2 identification | 2 move | 2 purpose | 2 reply | 1 structure | 1 tactical check

MIXED TEST 16 OF 60

Identify, choose, explain



YOUR COMPLETE ANSWER

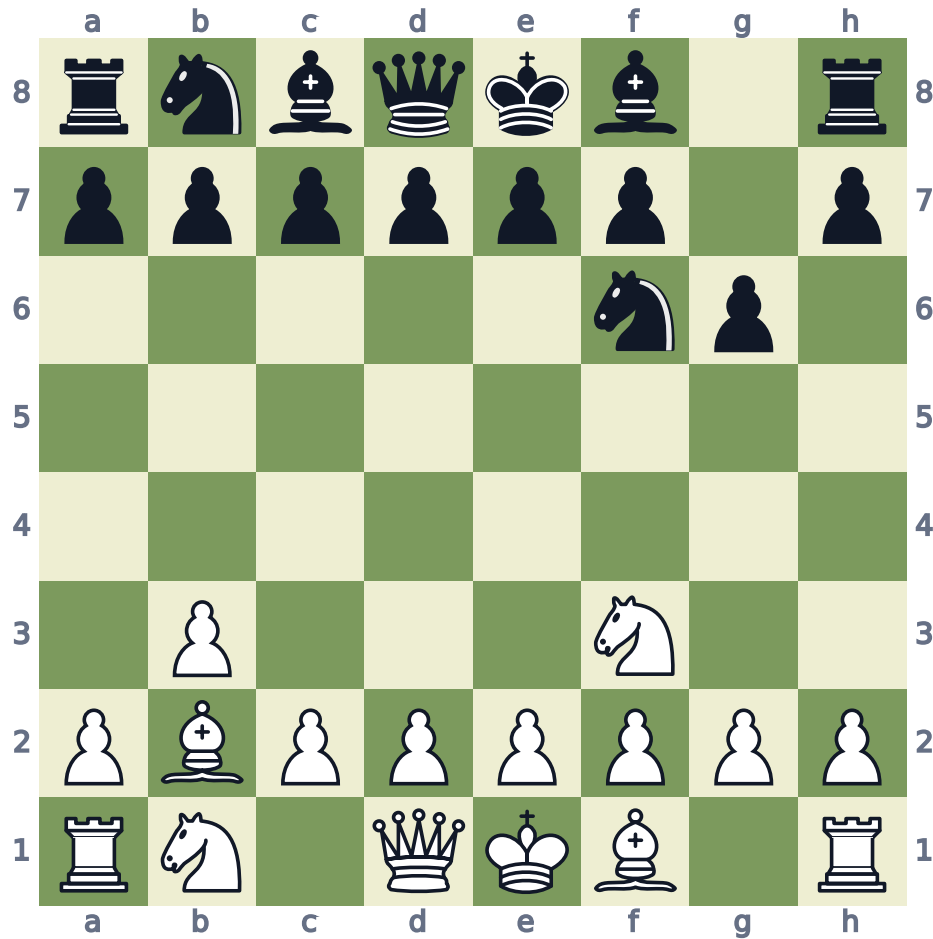
Black to move. Identify the setup and move-order clue. Choose the course move. Explain the purpose, the opponent's best practical reply, the likely pawn structure, and the tactical feature that must be checked before moving.

TEN-POINT SCORE

2 identification | 2 move | 2 purpose | 2 reply | 1 structure | 1 tactical check

MIXED TEST 17 OF 60

Identify, choose, explain



YOUR COMPLETE ANSWER

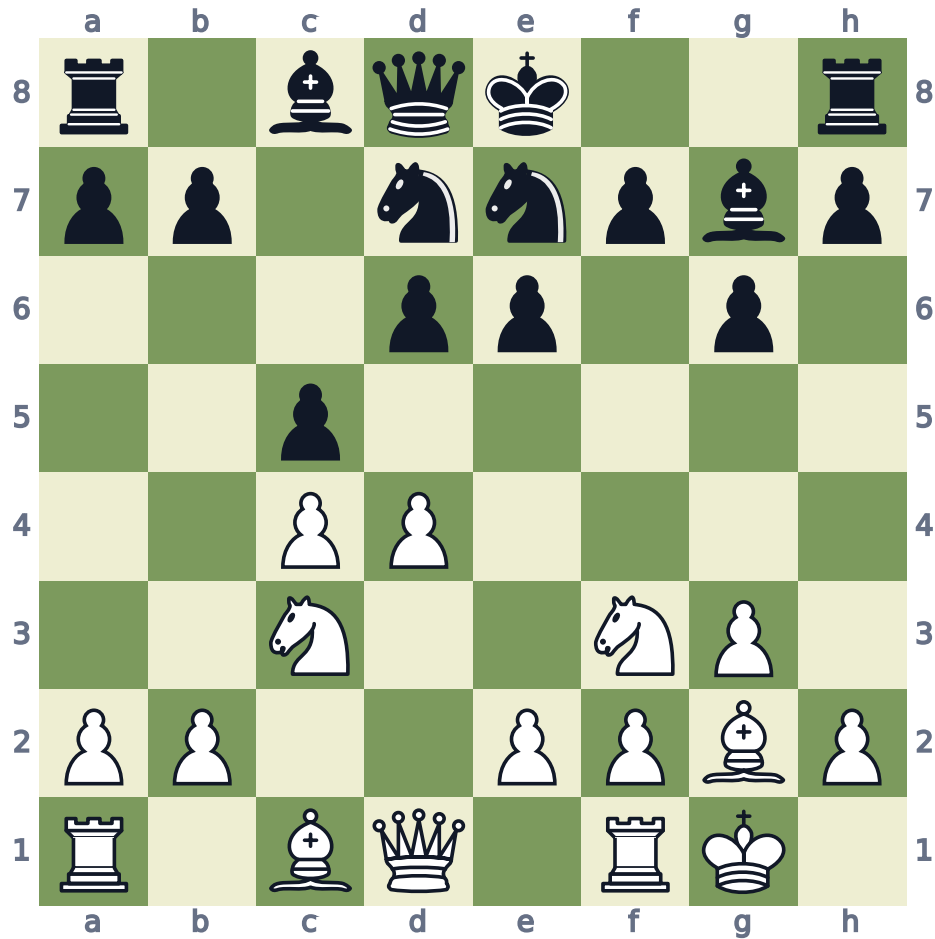
Black to move. Identify the setup and move-order clue. Choose the course move. Explain the purpose, the opponent's best practical reply, the likely pawn structure, and the tactical feature that must be checked before moving.

TEN-POINT SCORE

2 identification | 2 move | 2 purpose | 2 reply | 1 structure | 1 tactical check

MIXED TEST 18 OF 60

Identify, choose, explain



YOUR COMPLETE ANSWER

White to move. Identify the setup and move-order clue. Choose the course move. Explain the purpose, the opponent's best practical reply, the likely pawn structure, and the tactical feature that must be checked before moving.

TEN-POINT SCORE

2 identification | 2 move | 2 purpose | 2 reply | 1 structure | 1 tactical check

MIXED TEST 19 OF 60

Identify, choose, explain



YOUR COMPLETE ANSWER

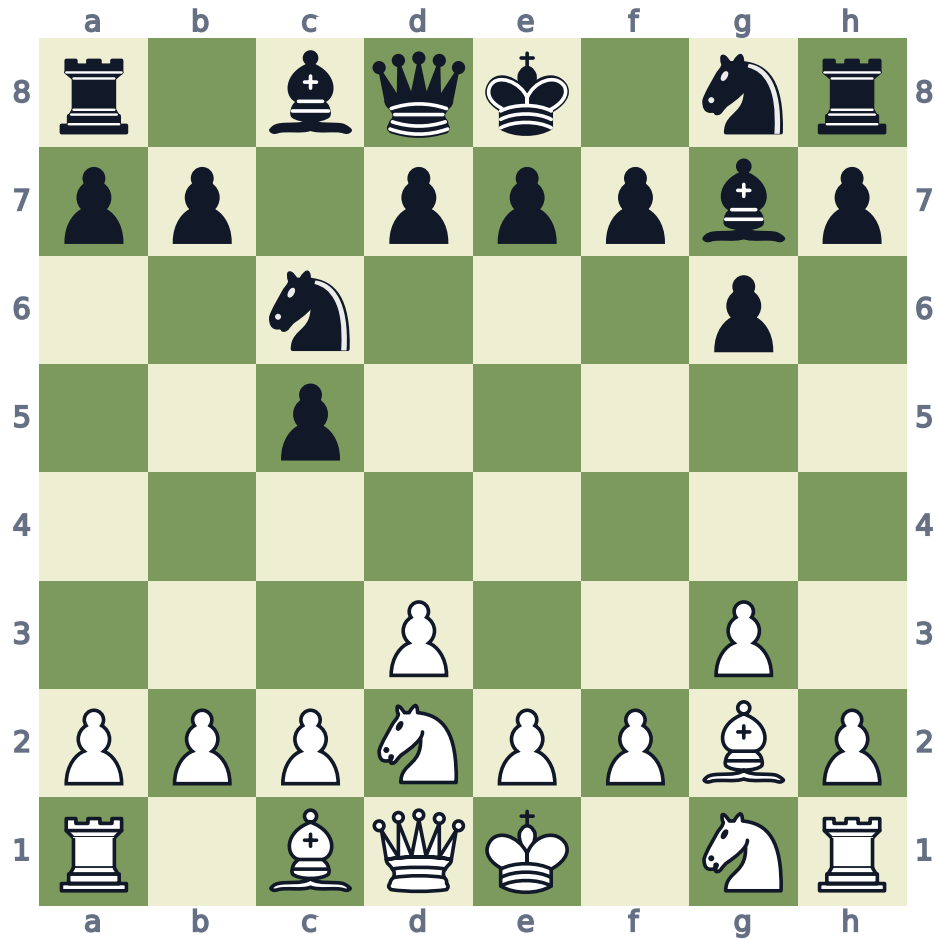
Black to move. Identify the setup and move-order clue. Choose the course move. Explain the purpose, the opponent's best practical reply, the likely pawn structure, and the tactical feature that must be checked before moving.

TEN-POINT SCORE

2 identification | 2 move | 2 purpose | 2 reply | 1 structure | 1 tactical check

MIXED TEST 20 OF 60

Identify, choose, explain



YOUR COMPLETE ANSWER

White to move. Identify the setup and move-order clue. Choose the course move. Explain the purpose, the opponent's best practical reply, the likely pawn structure, and the tactical feature that must be checked before moving.

TEN-POINT SCORE

2 identification | 2 move | 2 purpose | 2 reply | 1 structure | 1 tactical check

MIXED TEST 21 OF 60

Identify, choose, explain



YOUR COMPLETE ANSWER

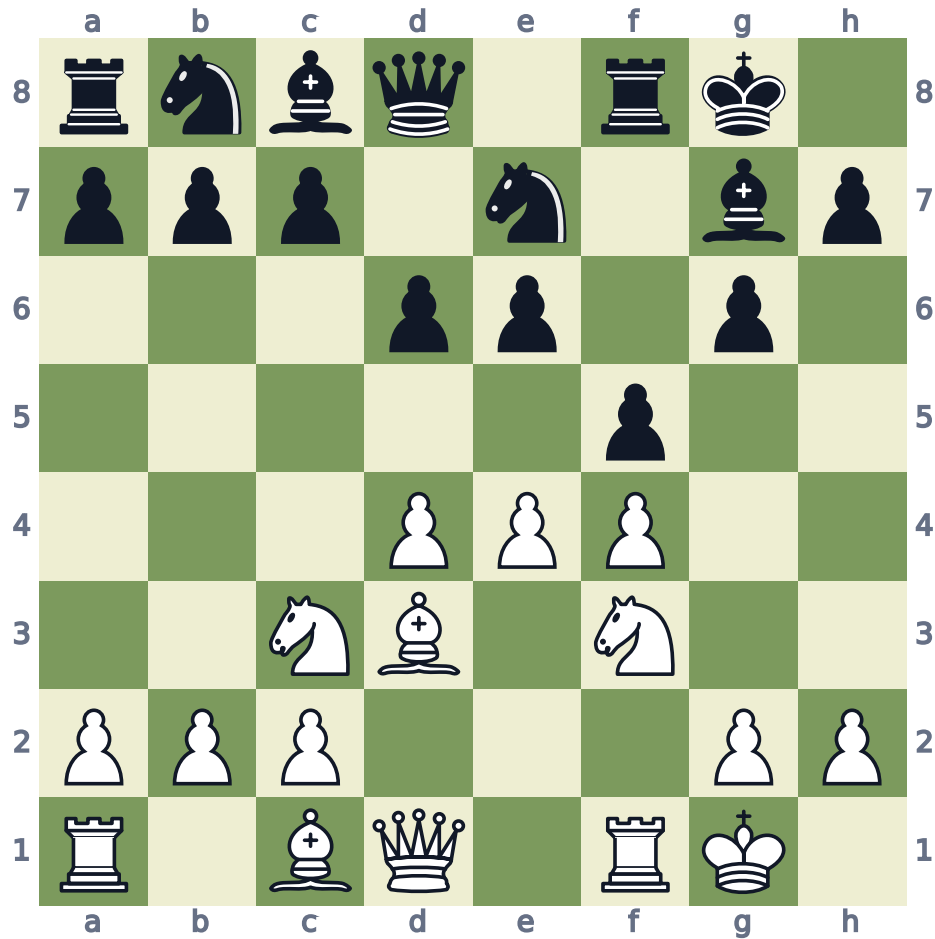
Black to move. Identify the setup and move-order clue. Choose the course move. Explain the purpose, the opponent's best practical reply, the likely pawn structure, and the tactical feature that must be checked before moving.

TEN-POINT SCORE

2 identification | 2 move | 2 purpose | 2 reply | 1 structure | 1 tactical check

MIXED TEST 22 OF 60

Identify, choose, explain



YOUR COMPLETE ANSWER

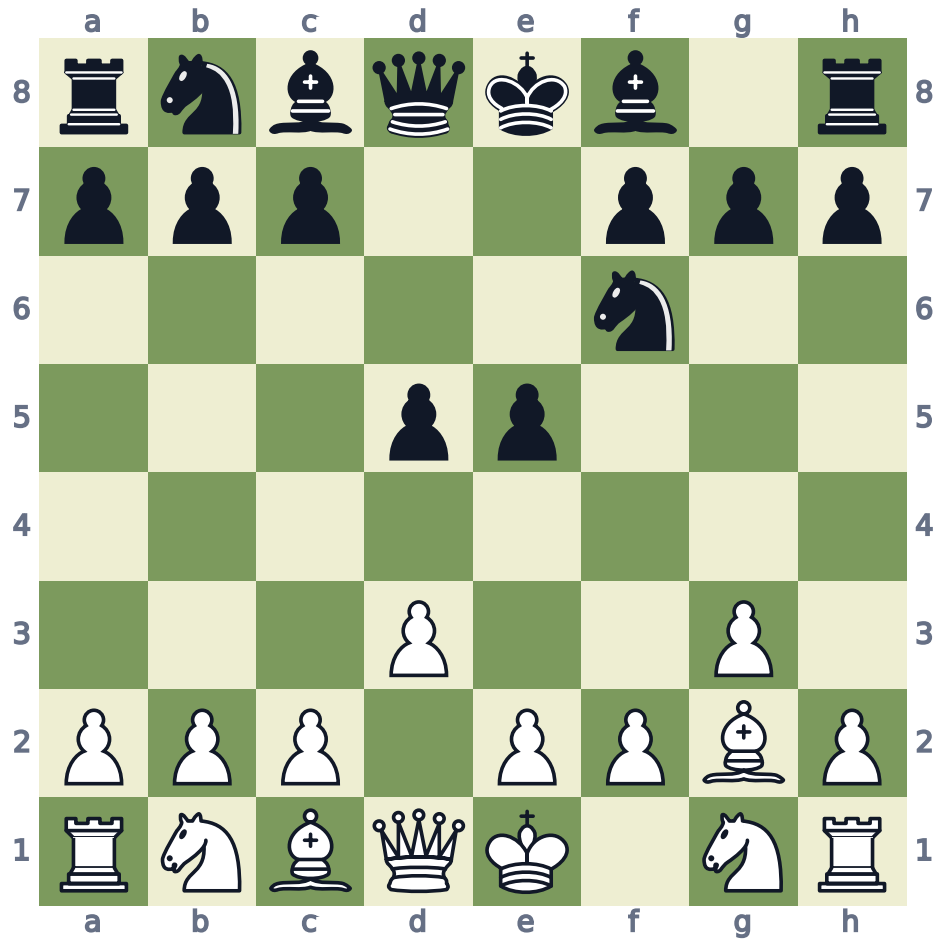
White to move. Identify the setup and move-order clue. Choose the course move. Explain the purpose, the opponent's best practical reply, the likely pawn structure, and the tactical feature that must be checked before moving.

TEN-POINT SCORE

2 identification | 2 move | 2 purpose | 2 reply | 1 structure | 1 tactical check

MIXED TEST 23 OF 60

Identify, choose, explain



YOUR COMPLETE ANSWER

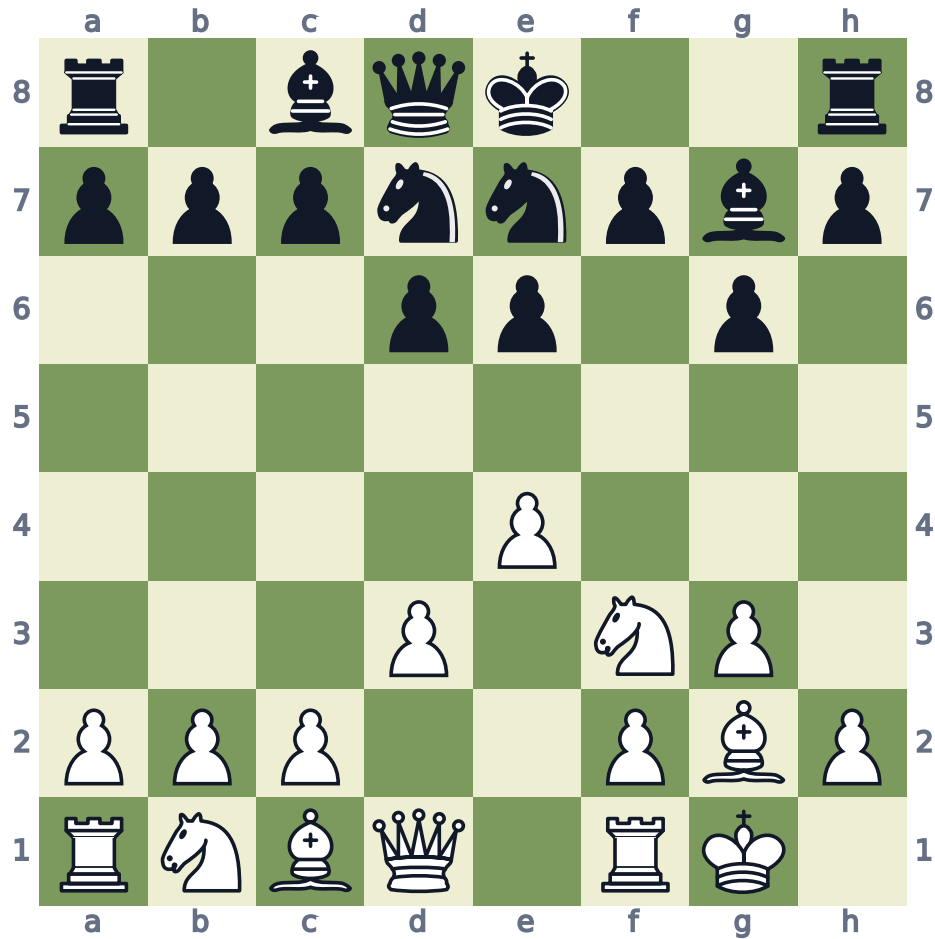
White to move. Identify the setup and move-order clue. Choose the course move. Explain the purpose, the opponent's best practical reply, the likely pawn structure, and the tactical feature that must be checked before moving.

TEN-POINT SCORE

2 identification | 2 move | 2 purpose | 2 reply | 1 structure | 1 tactical check

MIXED TEST 24 OF 60

Identify, choose, explain



YOUR COMPLETE ANSWER

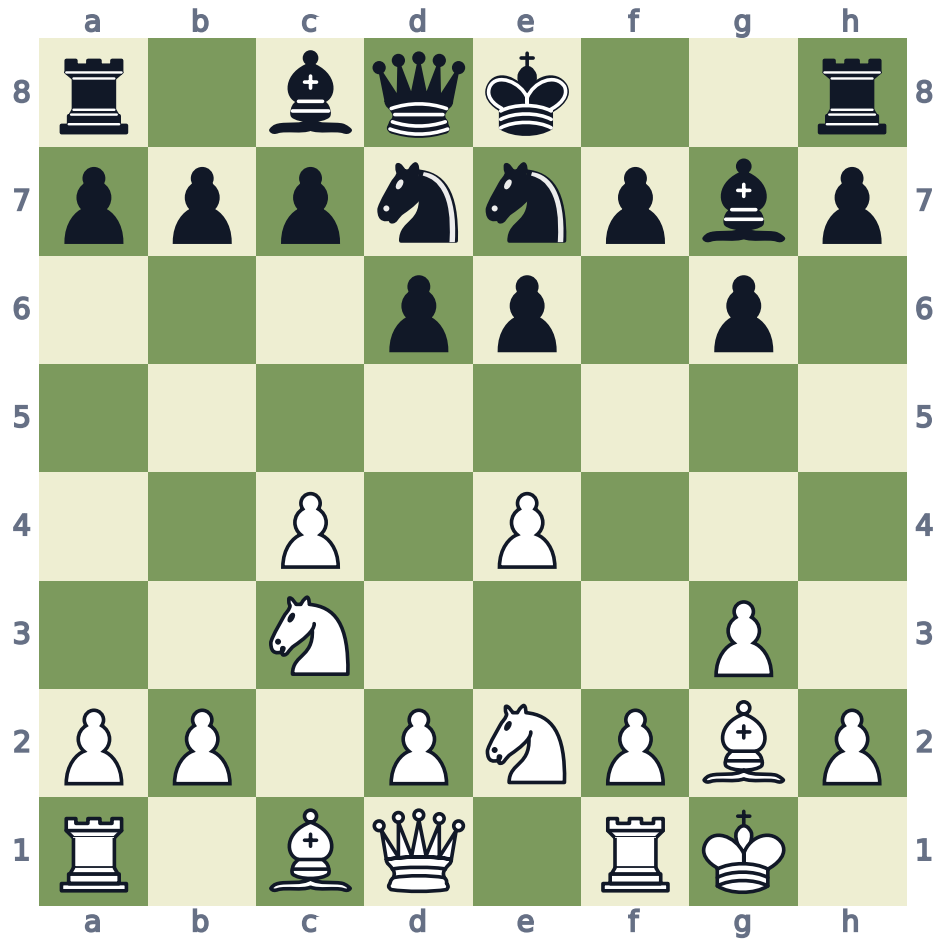
White to move. Identify the setup and move-order clue. Choose the course move. Explain the purpose, the opponent's best practical reply, the likely pawn structure, and the tactical feature that must be checked before moving.

TEN-POINT SCORE

2 identification | 2 move | 2 purpose | 2 reply | 1 structure | 1 tactical check

MIXED TEST 25 OF 60

Identify, choose, explain



YOUR COMPLETE ANSWER

Black to move. Identify the setup and move-order clue. Choose the course move. Explain the purpose, the opponent's best practical reply, the likely pawn structure, and the tactical feature that must be checked before moving.

TEN-POINT SCORE

2 identification | 2 move | 2 purpose | 2 reply | 1 structure | 1 tactical check

MIXED TEST 26 OF 60

Identify, choose, explain



YOUR COMPLETE ANSWER

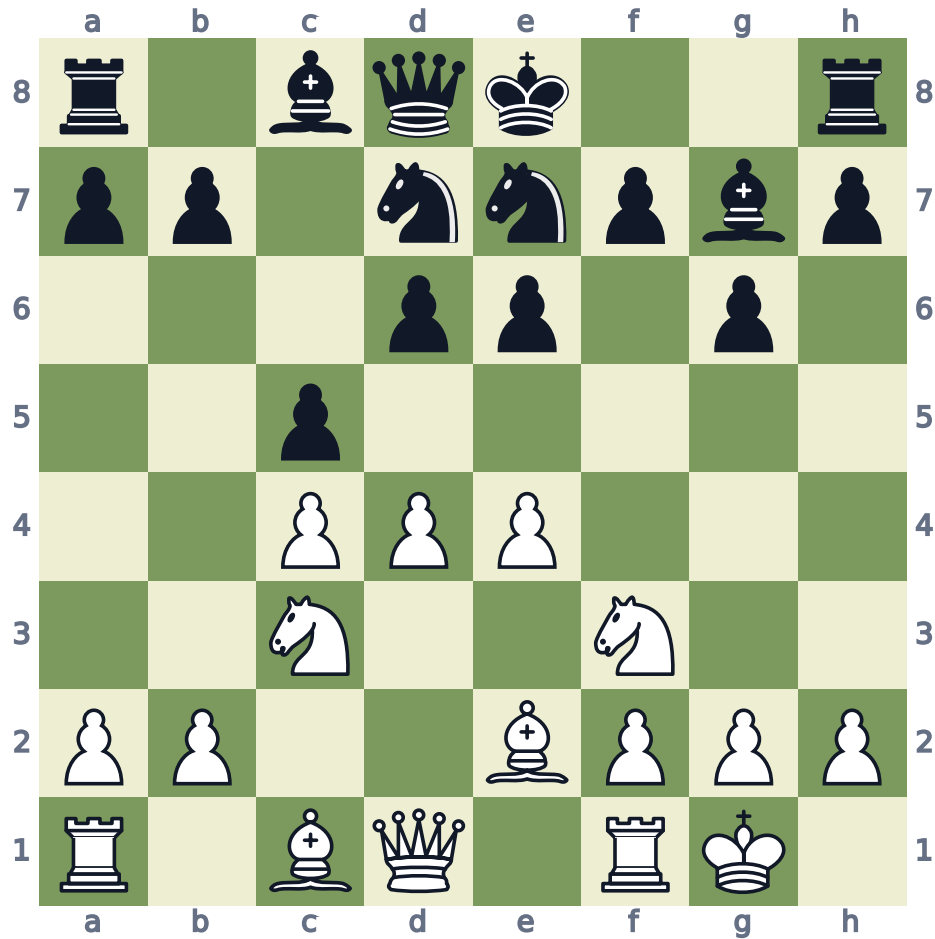
Black to move. Identify the setup and move-order clue. Choose the course move. Explain the purpose, the opponent's best practical reply, the likely pawn structure, and the tactical feature that must be checked before moving.

TEN-POINT SCORE

2 identification | 2 move | 2 purpose | 2 reply | 1 structure | 1 tactical check

MIXED TEST 27 OF 60

Identify, choose, explain



YOUR COMPLETE ANSWER

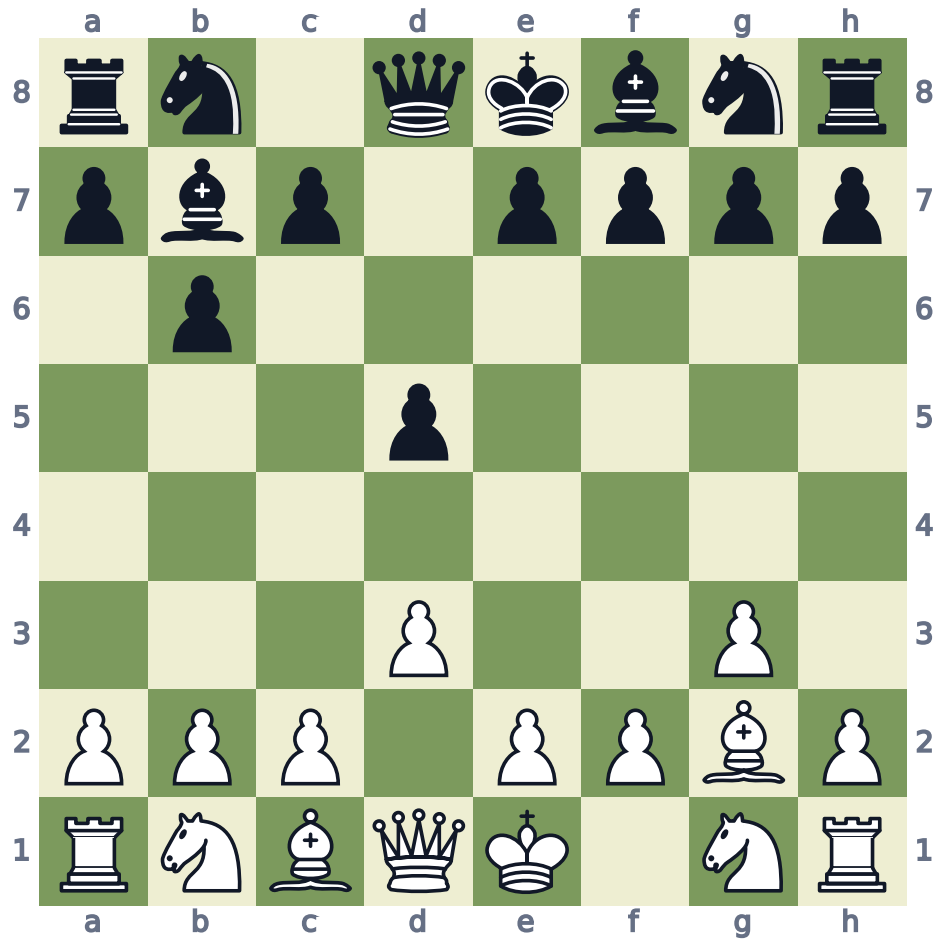
White to move. Identify the setup and move-order clue. Choose the course move. Explain the purpose, the opponent's best practical reply, the likely pawn structure, and the tactical feature that must be checked before moving.

TEN-POINT SCORE

2 identification | 2 move | 2 purpose | 2 reply | 1 structure | 1 tactical check

MIXED TEST 28 OF 60

Identify, choose, explain



YOUR COMPLETE ANSWER

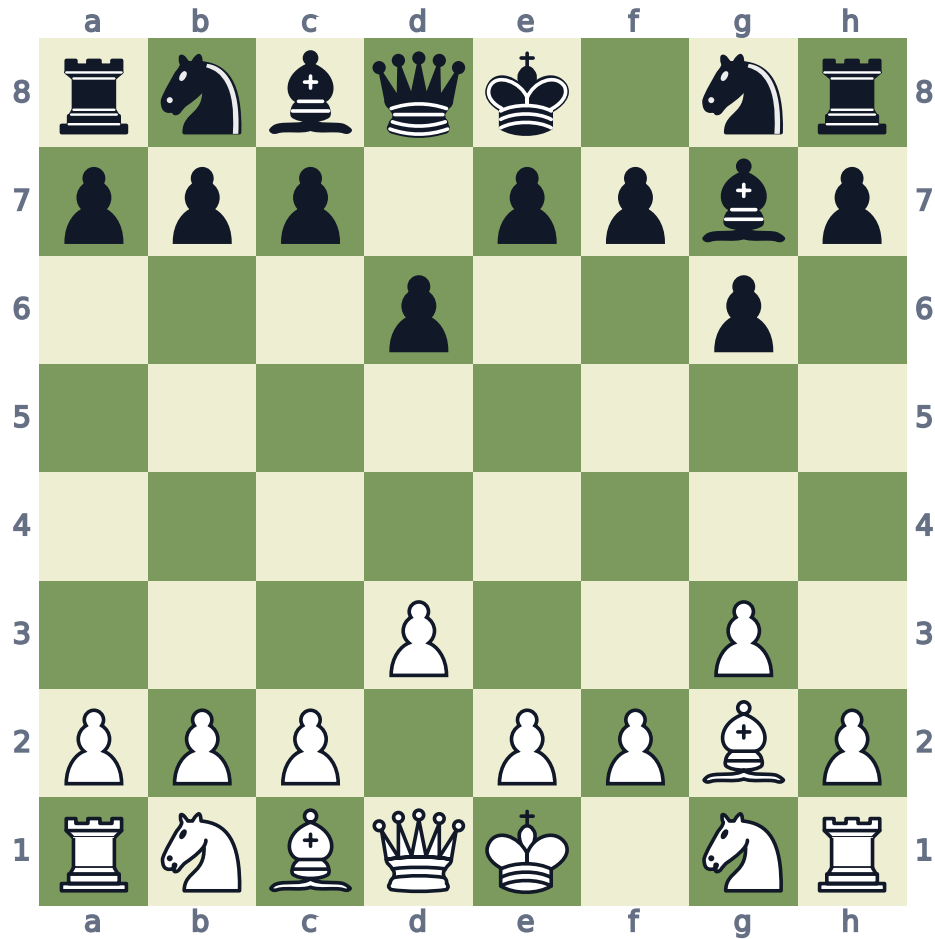
White to move. Identify the setup and move-order clue. Choose the course move. Explain the purpose, the opponent's best practical reply, the likely pawn structure, and the tactical feature that must be checked before moving.

TEN-POINT SCORE

2 identification | 2 move | 2 purpose | 2 reply | 1 structure | 1 tactical check

MIXED TEST 29 OF 60

Identify, choose, explain



YOUR COMPLETE ANSWER

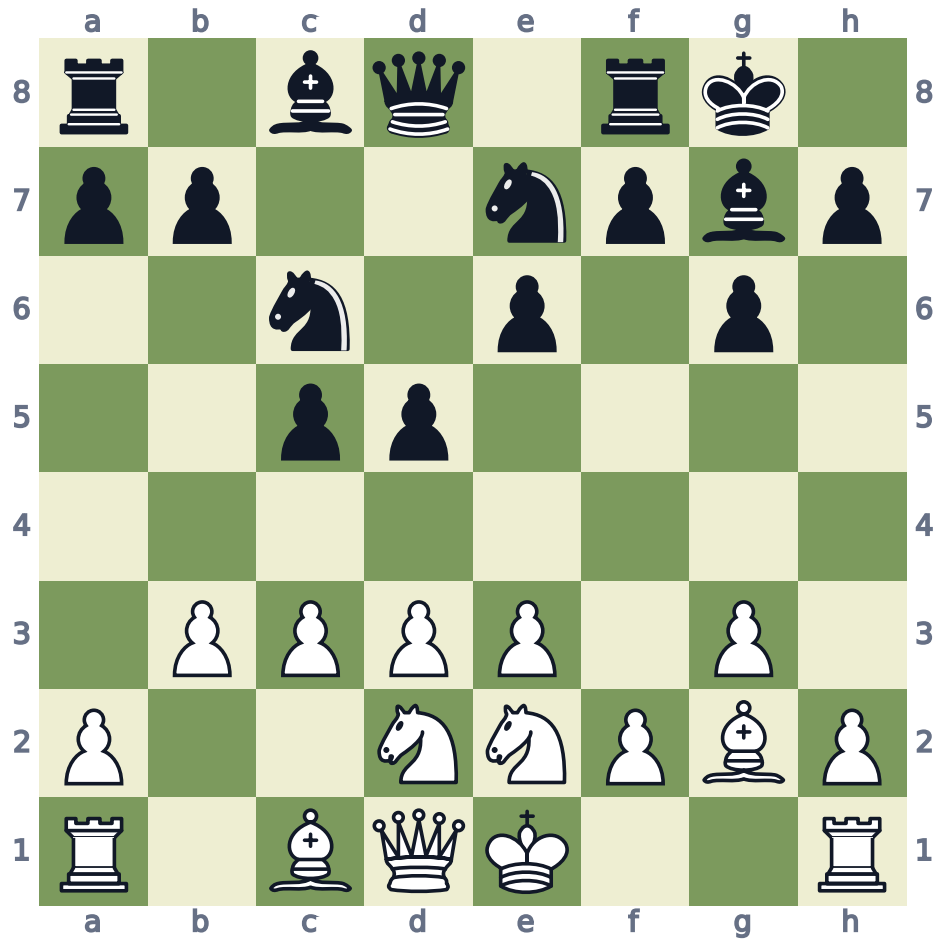
White to move. Identify the setup and move-order clue. Choose the course move. Explain the purpose, the opponent's best practical reply, the likely pawn structure, and the tactical feature that must be checked before moving.

TEN-POINT SCORE

2 identification | 2 move | 2 purpose | 2 reply | 1 structure | 1 tactical check

MIXED TEST 30 OF 60

Identify, choose, explain



YOUR COMPLETE ANSWER

White to move. Identify the setup and move-order clue. Choose the course move. Explain the purpose, the opponent's best practical reply, the likely pawn structure, and the tactical feature that must be checked before moving.

TEN-POINT SCORE

2 identification | 2 move | 2 purpose | 2 reply | 1 structure | 1 tactical check

MIXED TEST 31 OF 60

Identify, choose, explain



YOUR COMPLETE ANSWER

Black to move. Identify the setup and move-order clue. Choose the course move. Explain the purpose, the opponent's best practical reply, the likely pawn structure, and the tactical feature that must be checked before moving.

TEN-POINT SCORE

2 identification | 2 move | 2 purpose | 2 reply | 1 structure | 1 tactical check

MIXED TEST 32 OF 60

Identify, choose, explain



YOUR COMPLETE ANSWER

Black to move. Identify the setup and move-order clue. Choose the course move. Explain the purpose, the opponent's best practical reply, the likely pawn structure, and the tactical feature that must be checked before moving.

TEN-POINT SCORE

2 identification | 2 move | 2 purpose | 2 reply | 1 structure | 1 tactical check

MIXED TEST 33 OF 60

Identify, choose, explain



YOUR COMPLETE ANSWER

Black to move. Identify the setup and move-order clue. Choose the course move. Explain the purpose, the opponent's best practical reply, the likely pawn structure, and the tactical feature that must be checked before moving.

TEN-POINT SCORE

2 identification | 2 move | 2 purpose | 2 reply | 1 structure | 1 tactical check

MIXED TEST 34 OF 60

Identify, choose, explain



YOUR COMPLETE ANSWER

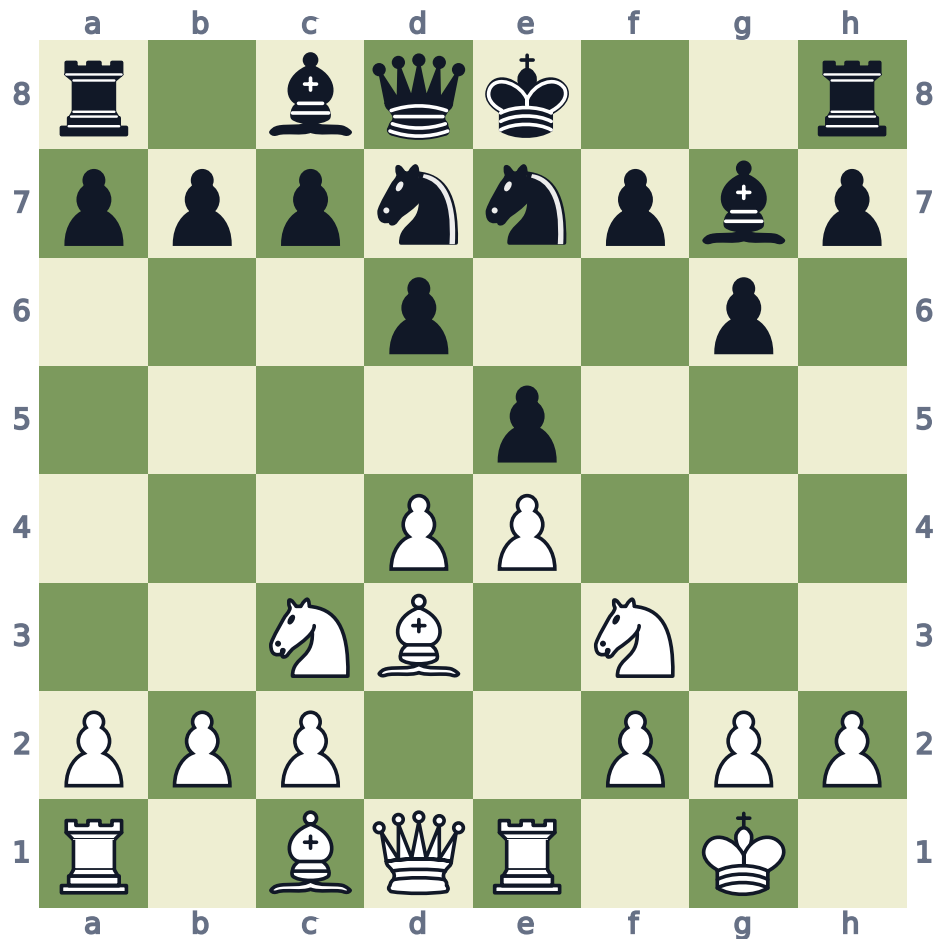
Black to move. Identify the setup and move-order clue. Choose the course move. Explain the purpose, the opponent's best practical reply, the likely pawn structure, and the tactical feature that must be checked before moving.

TEN-POINT SCORE

2 identification | 2 move | 2 purpose | 2 reply | 1 structure | 1 tactical check

MIXED TEST 35 OF 60

Identify, choose, explain



YOUR COMPLETE ANSWER

White to move. Identify the setup and move-order clue. Choose the course move. Explain the purpose, the opponent's best practical reply, the likely pawn structure, and the tactical feature that must be checked before moving.

TEN-POINT SCORE

2 identification | 2 move | 2 purpose | 2 reply | 1 structure | 1 tactical check

MIXED TEST 36 OF 60

Identify, choose, explain



YOUR COMPLETE ANSWER

White to move. Identify the setup and move-order clue. Choose the course move. Explain the purpose, the opponent's best practical reply, the likely pawn structure, and the tactical feature that must be checked before moving.

TEN-POINT SCORE

2 identification | 2 move | 2 purpose | 2 reply | 1 structure | 1 tactical check

MIXED TEST 37 OF 60

Identify, choose, explain



YOUR COMPLETE ANSWER

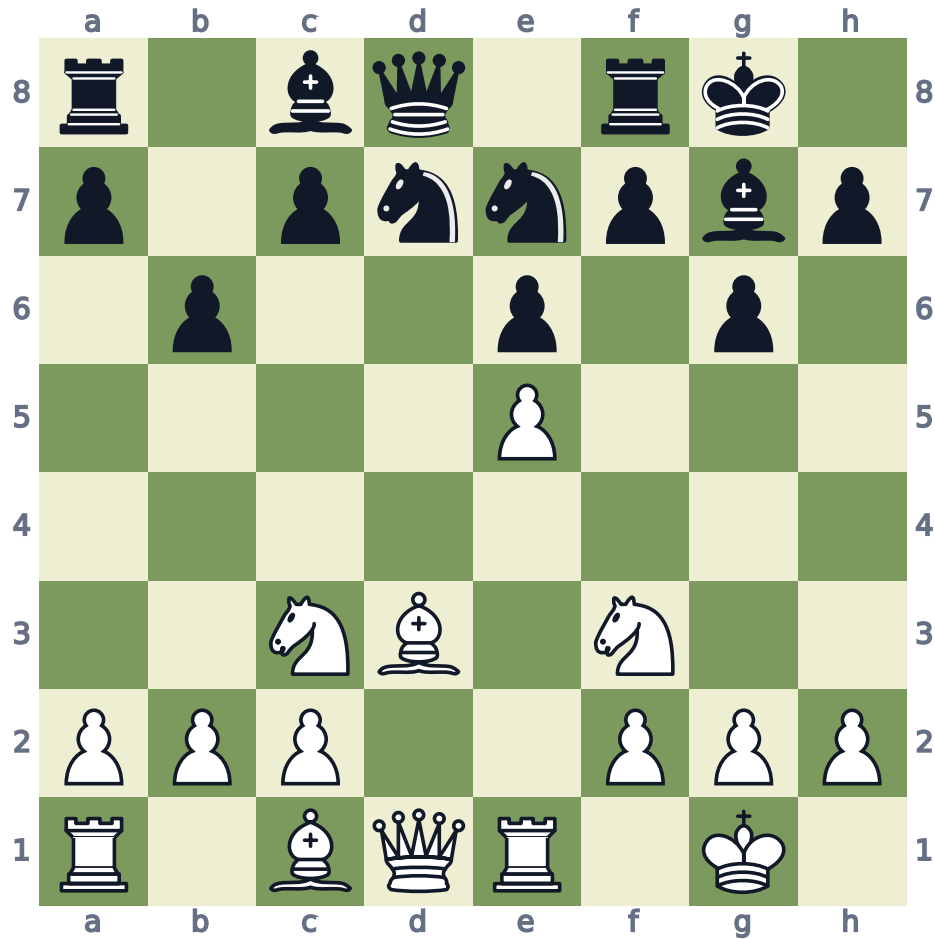
Black to move. Identify the setup and move-order clue. Choose the course move. Explain the purpose, the opponent's best practical reply, the likely pawn structure, and the tactical feature that must be checked before moving.

TEN-POINT SCORE

2 identification | 2 move | 2 purpose | 2 reply | 1 structure | 1 tactical check

MIXED TEST 38 OF 60

Identify, choose, explain



YOUR COMPLETE ANSWER

White to move. Identify the setup and move-order clue. Choose the course move. Explain the purpose, the opponent's best practical reply, the likely pawn structure, and the tactical feature that must be checked before moving.

TEN-POINT SCORE

2 identification | 2 move | 2 purpose | 2 reply | 1 structure | 1 tactical check

MIXED TEST 39 OF 60

Identify, choose, explain



YOUR COMPLETE ANSWER

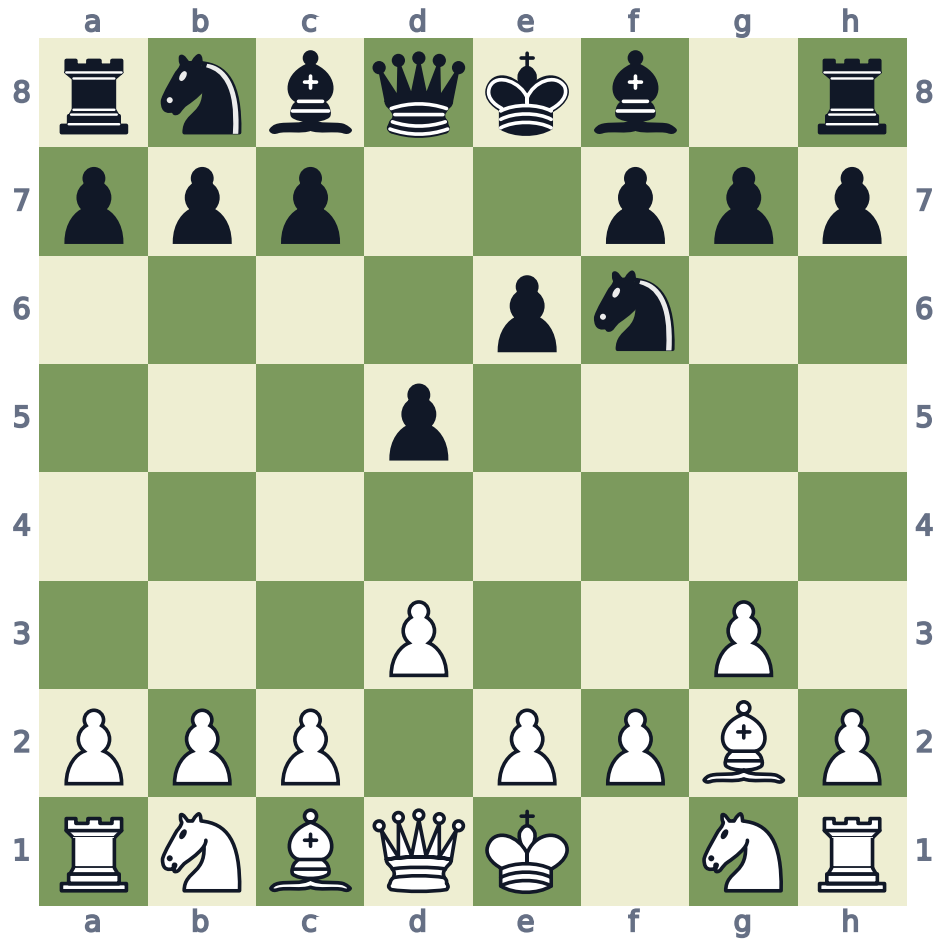
Black to move. Identify the setup and move-order clue. Choose the course move. Explain the purpose, the opponent's best practical reply, the likely pawn structure, and the tactical feature that must be checked before moving.

TEN-POINT SCORE

2 identification | 2 move | 2 purpose | 2 reply | 1 structure | 1 tactical check

MIXED TEST 40 OF 60

Identify, choose, explain



YOUR COMPLETE ANSWER

White to move. Identify the setup and move-order clue. Choose the course move. Explain the purpose, the opponent's best practical reply, the likely pawn structure, and the tactical feature that must be checked before moving.

TEN-POINT SCORE

2 identification | 2 move | 2 purpose | 2 reply | 1 structure | 1 tactical check

MIXED TEST 41 OF 60

Identify, choose, explain



YOUR COMPLETE ANSWER

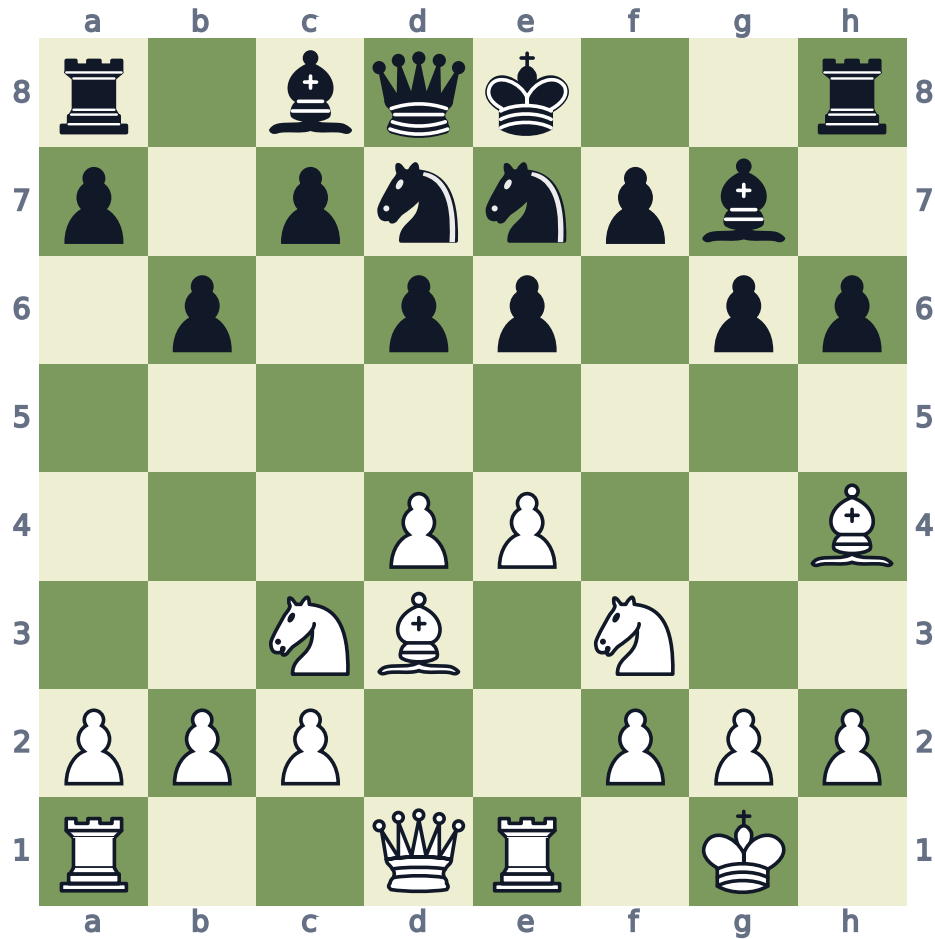
Black to move. Identify the setup and move-order clue. Choose the course move. Explain the purpose, the opponent's best practical reply, the likely pawn structure, and the tactical feature that must be checked before moving.

TEN-POINT SCORE

2 identification | 2 move | 2 purpose | 2 reply | 1 structure | 1 tactical check

MIXED TEST 42 OF 60

Identify, choose, explain



YOUR COMPLETE ANSWER

Black to move. Identify the setup and move-order clue. Choose the course move. Explain the purpose, the opponent's best practical reply, the likely pawn structure, and the tactical feature that must be checked before moving.

TEN-POINT SCORE

2 identification | 2 move | 2 purpose | 2 reply | 1 structure | 1 tactical check

MIXED TEST 43 OF 60

Identify, choose, explain



YOUR COMPLETE ANSWER

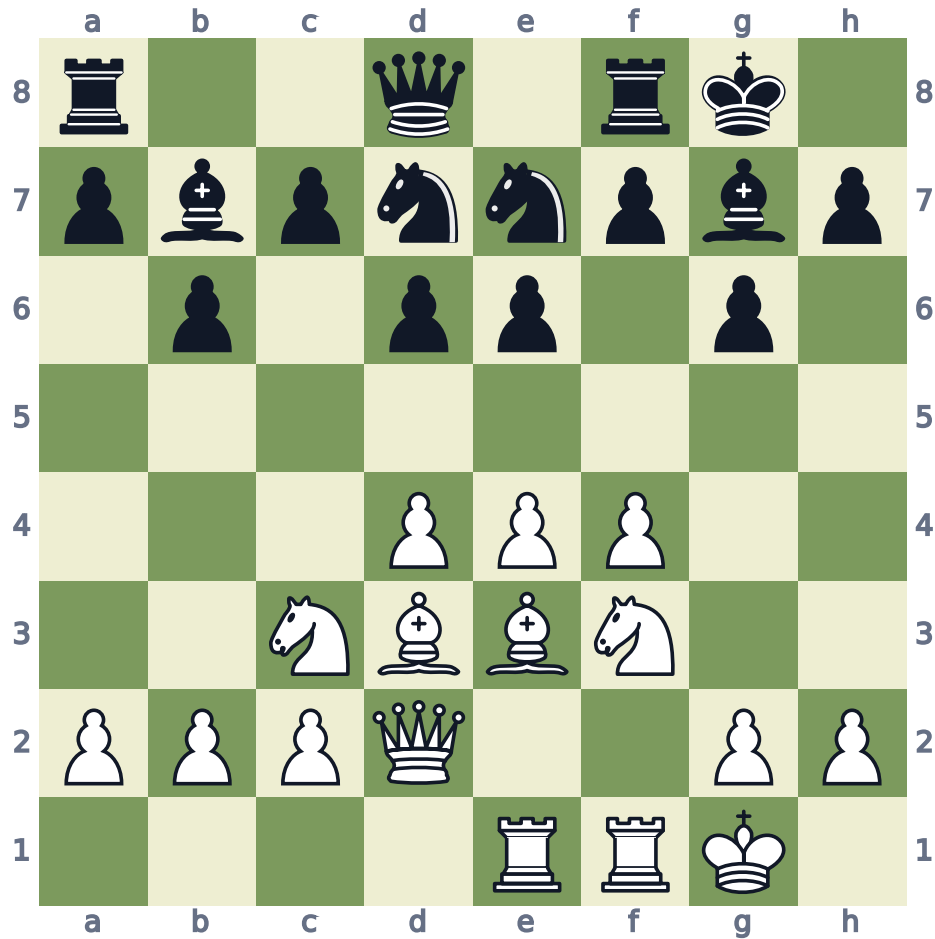
Black to move. Identify the setup and move-order clue. Choose the course move. Explain the purpose, the opponent's best practical reply, the likely pawn structure, and the tactical feature that must be checked before moving.

TEN-POINT SCORE

2 identification | 2 move | 2 purpose | 2 reply | 1 structure | 1 tactical check

MIXED TEST 44 OF 60

Identify, choose, explain



YOUR COMPLETE ANSWER

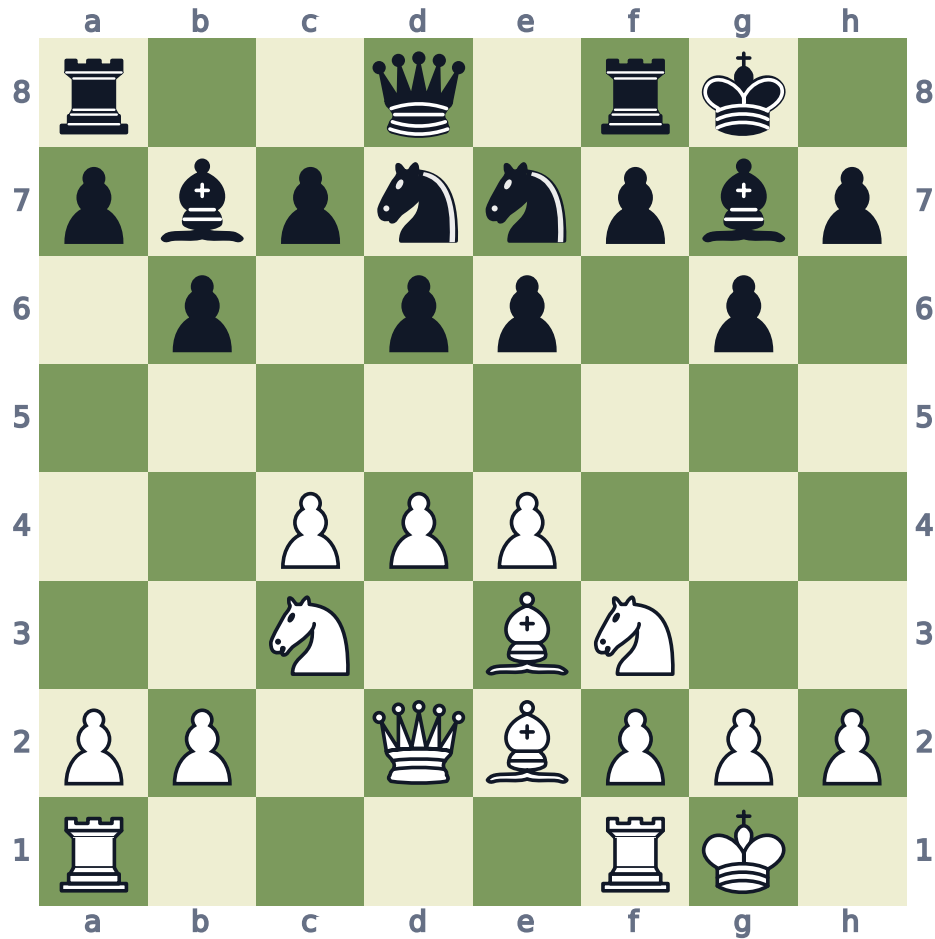
Black to move. Identify the setup and move-order clue. Choose the course move. Explain the purpose, the opponent's best practical reply, the likely pawn structure, and the tactical feature that must be checked before moving.

TEN-POINT SCORE

2 identification | 2 move | 2 purpose | 2 reply | 1 structure | 1 tactical check

MIXED TEST 45 OF 60

Identify, choose, explain



YOUR COMPLETE ANSWER

White to move. Identify the setup and move-order clue. Choose the course move. Explain the purpose, the opponent's best practical reply, the likely pawn structure, and the tactical feature that must be checked before moving.

TEN-POINT SCORE

2 identification | 2 move | 2 purpose | 2 reply | 1 structure | 1 tactical check

MIXED TEST 46 OF 60

Identify, choose, explain



YOUR COMPLETE ANSWER

Black to move. Identify the setup and move-order clue. Choose the course move. Explain the purpose, the opponent's best practical reply, the likely pawn structure, and the tactical feature that must be checked before moving.

TEN-POINT SCORE

2 identification | 2 move | 2 purpose | 2 reply | 1 structure | 1 tactical check

MIXED TEST 47 OF 60

Identify, choose, explain



YOUR COMPLETE ANSWER

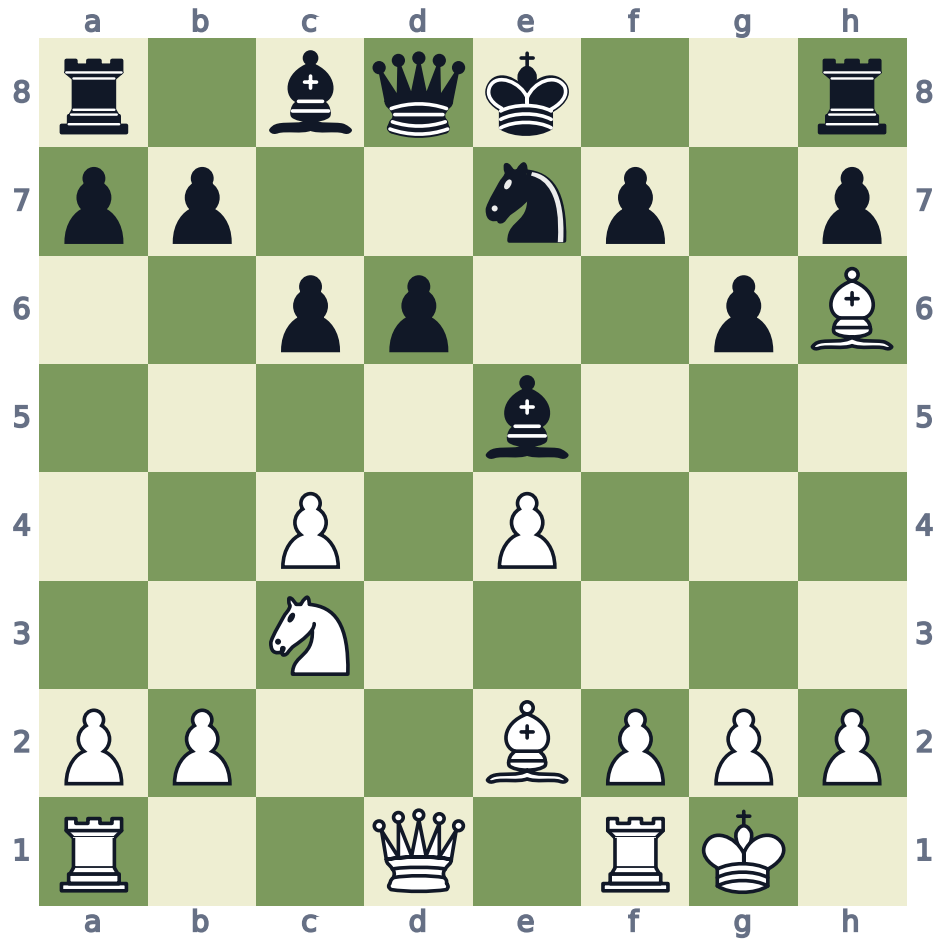
Black to move. Identify the setup and move-order clue. Choose the course move. Explain the purpose, the opponent's best practical reply, the likely pawn structure, and the tactical feature that must be checked before moving.

TEN-POINT SCORE

2 identification | 2 move | 2 purpose | 2 reply | 1 structure | 1 tactical check

MIXED TEST 48 OF 60

Identify, choose, explain



YOUR COMPLETE ANSWER

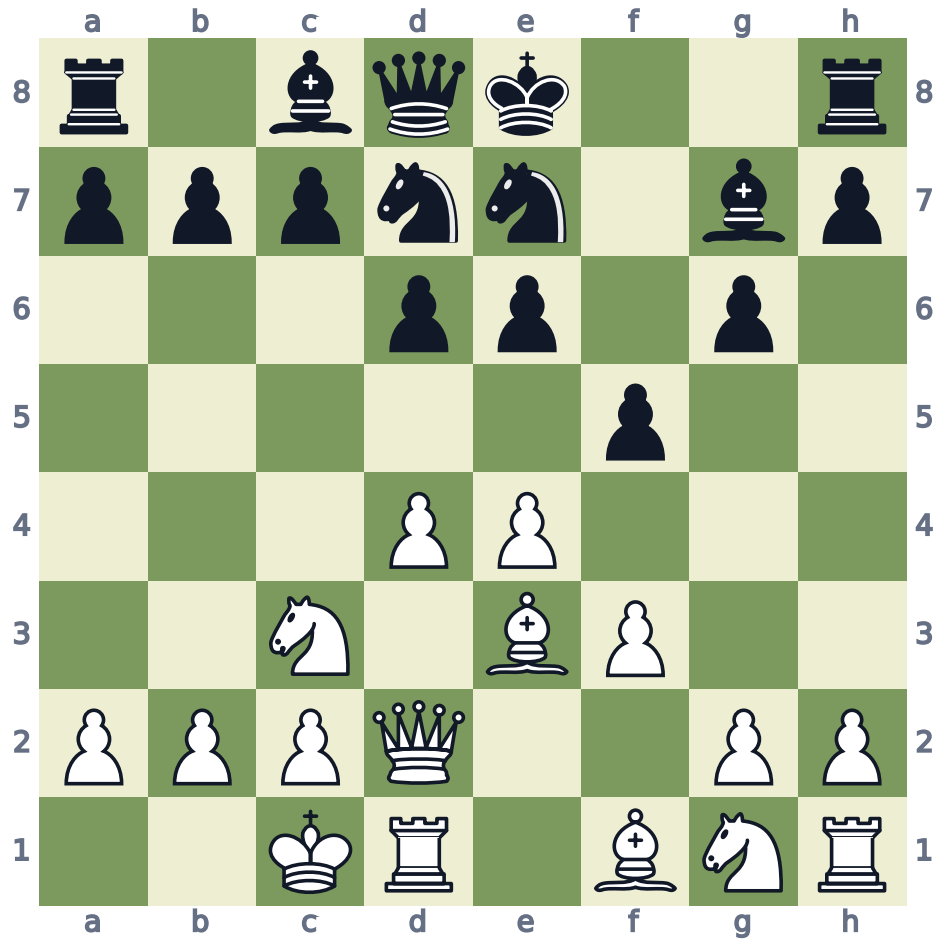
White to move. Identify the setup and move-order clue. Choose the course move. Explain the purpose, the opponent's best practical reply, the likely pawn structure, and the tactical feature that must be checked before moving.

TEN-POINT SCORE

2 identification | 2 move | 2 purpose | 2 reply | 1 structure | 1 tactical check

MIXED TEST 49 OF 60

Identify, choose, explain



YOUR COMPLETE ANSWER

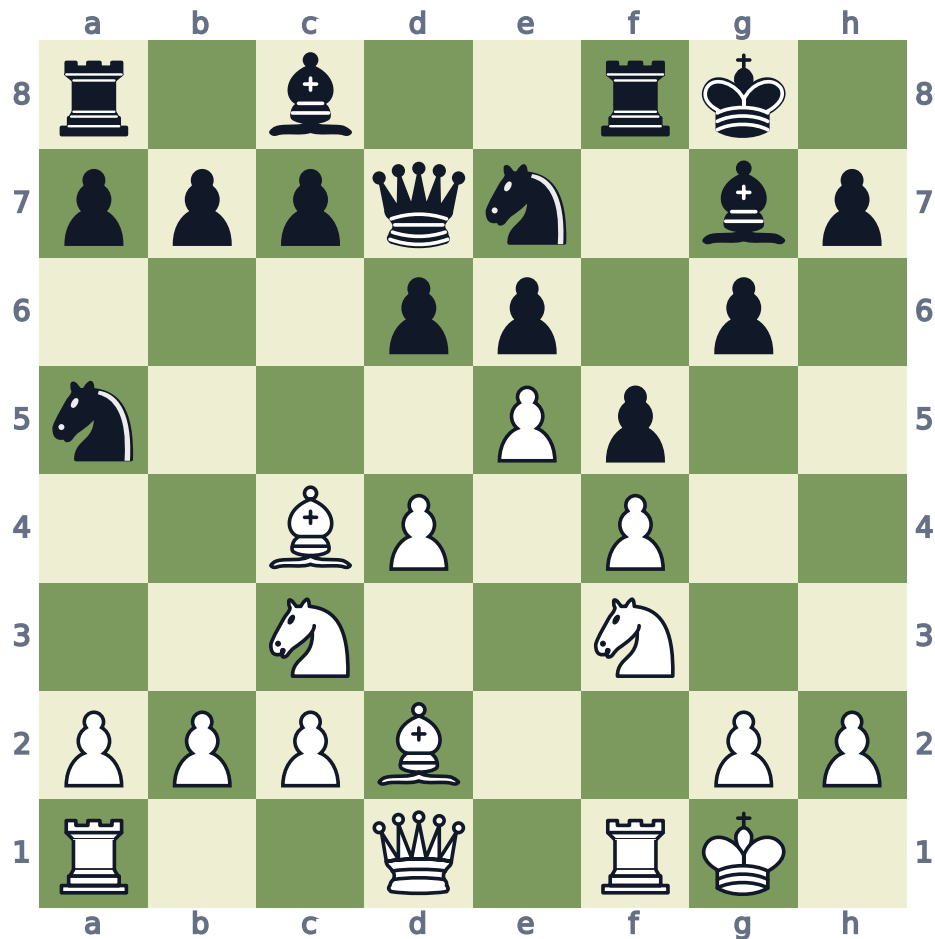
White to move. Identify the setup and move-order clue. Choose the course move. Explain the purpose, the opponent's best practical reply, the likely pawn structure, and the tactical feature that must be checked before moving.

TEN-POINT SCORE

2 identification | 2 move | 2 purpose | 2 reply | 1 structure | 1 tactical check

MIXED TEST 50 OF 60

Identify, choose, explain



YOUR COMPLETE ANSWER

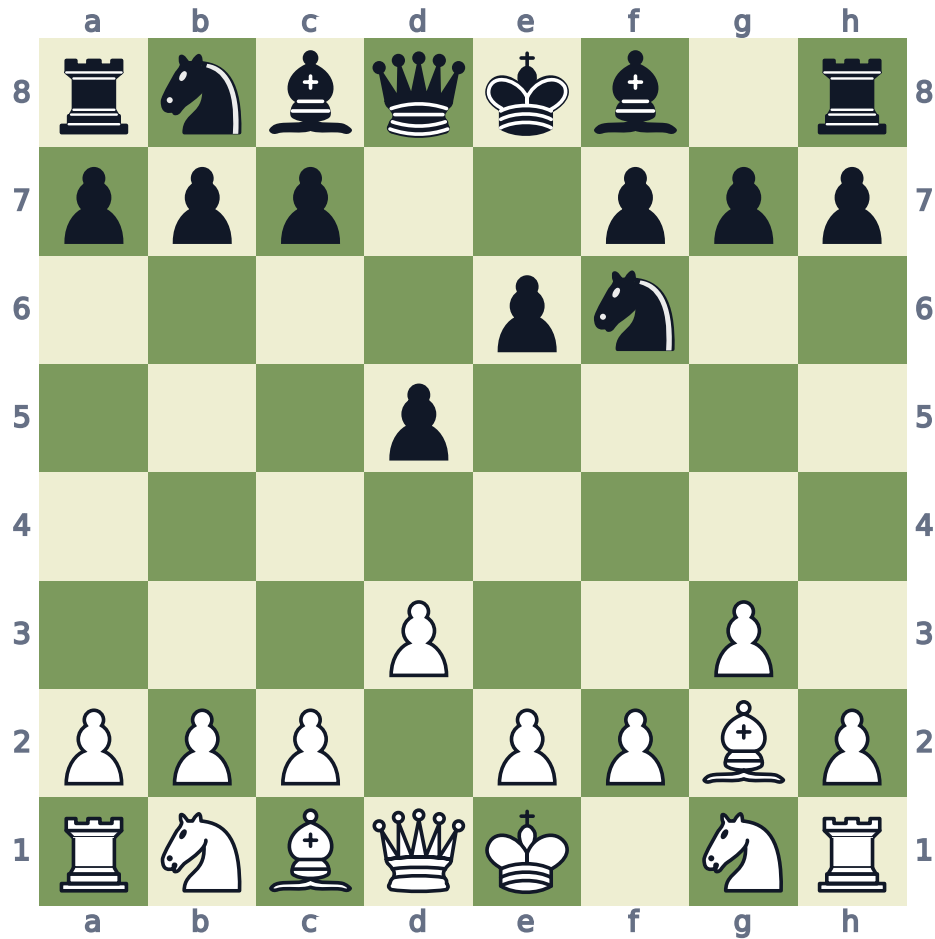
White to move. Identify the setup and move-order clue. Choose the course move. Explain the purpose, the opponent's best practical reply, the likely pawn structure, and the tactical feature that must be checked before moving.

TEN-POINT SCORE

2 identification | 2 move | 2 purpose | 2 reply | 1 structure | 1 tactical check

MIXED TEST 51 OF 60

Identify, choose, explain



YOUR COMPLETE ANSWER

White to move. Identify the setup and move-order clue. Choose the course move. Explain the purpose, the opponent's best practical reply, the likely pawn structure, and the tactical feature that must be checked before moving.

TEN-POINT SCORE

2 identification | 2 move | 2 purpose | 2 reply | 1 structure | 1 tactical check

MIXED TEST 52 OF 60

Identify, choose, explain



YOUR COMPLETE ANSWER

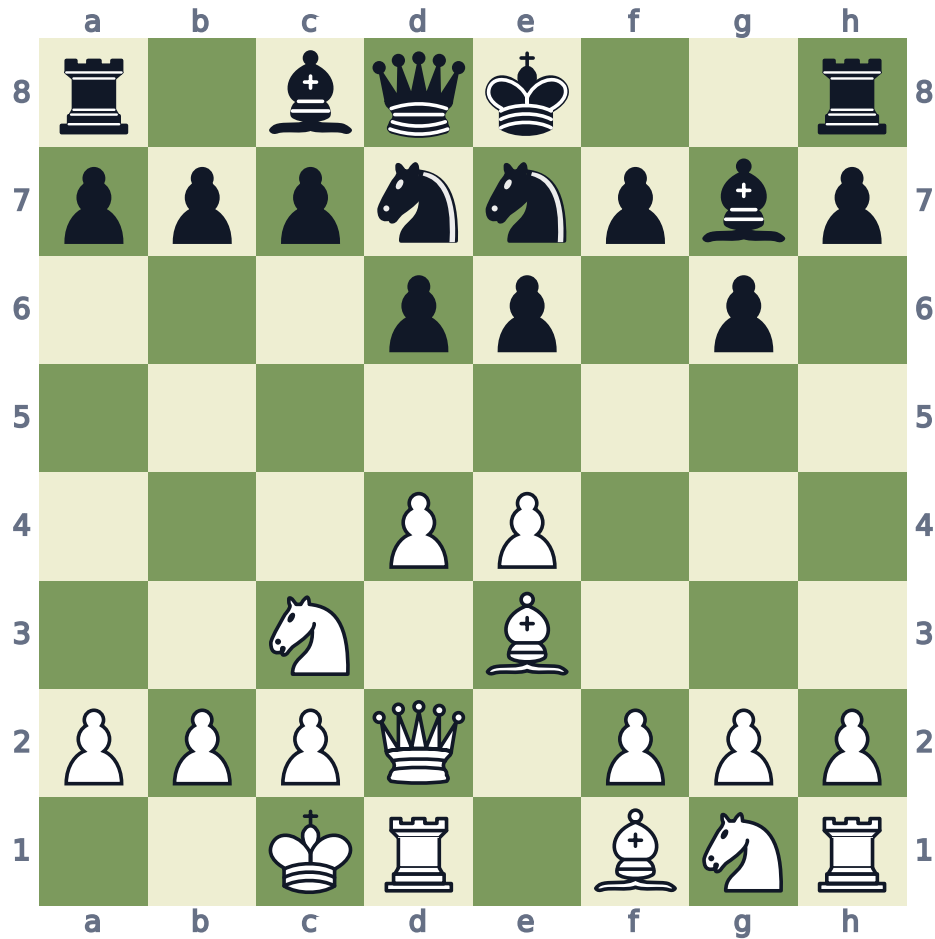
Black to move. Identify the setup and move-order clue. Choose the course move. Explain the purpose, the opponent's best practical reply, the likely pawn structure, and the tactical feature that must be checked before moving.

TEN-POINT SCORE

2 identification | 2 move | 2 purpose | 2 reply | 1 structure | 1 tactical check

MIXED TEST 53 OF 60

Identify, choose, explain



YOUR COMPLETE ANSWER

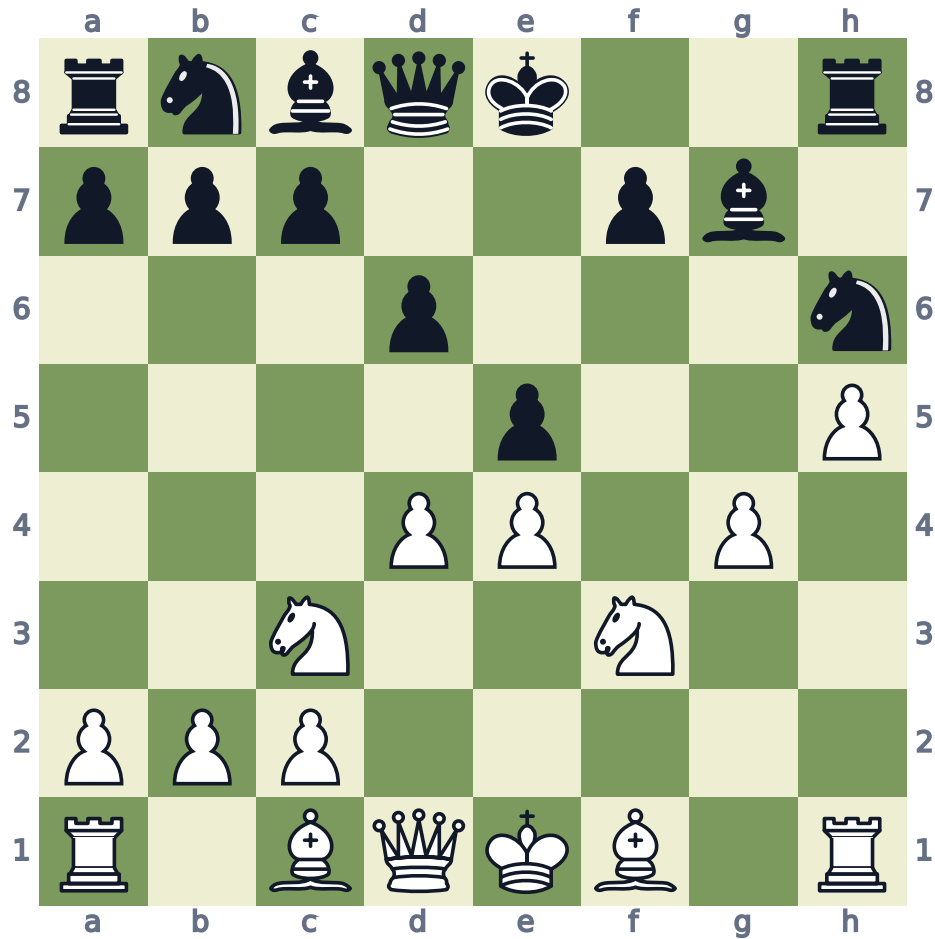
White to move. Identify the setup and move-order clue. Choose the course move. Explain the purpose, the opponent's best practical reply, the likely pawn structure, and the tactical feature that must be checked before moving.

TEN-POINT SCORE

2 identification | 2 move | 2 purpose | 2 reply | 1 structure | 1 tactical check

MIXED TEST 54 OF 60

Identify, choose, explain



YOUR COMPLETE ANSWER

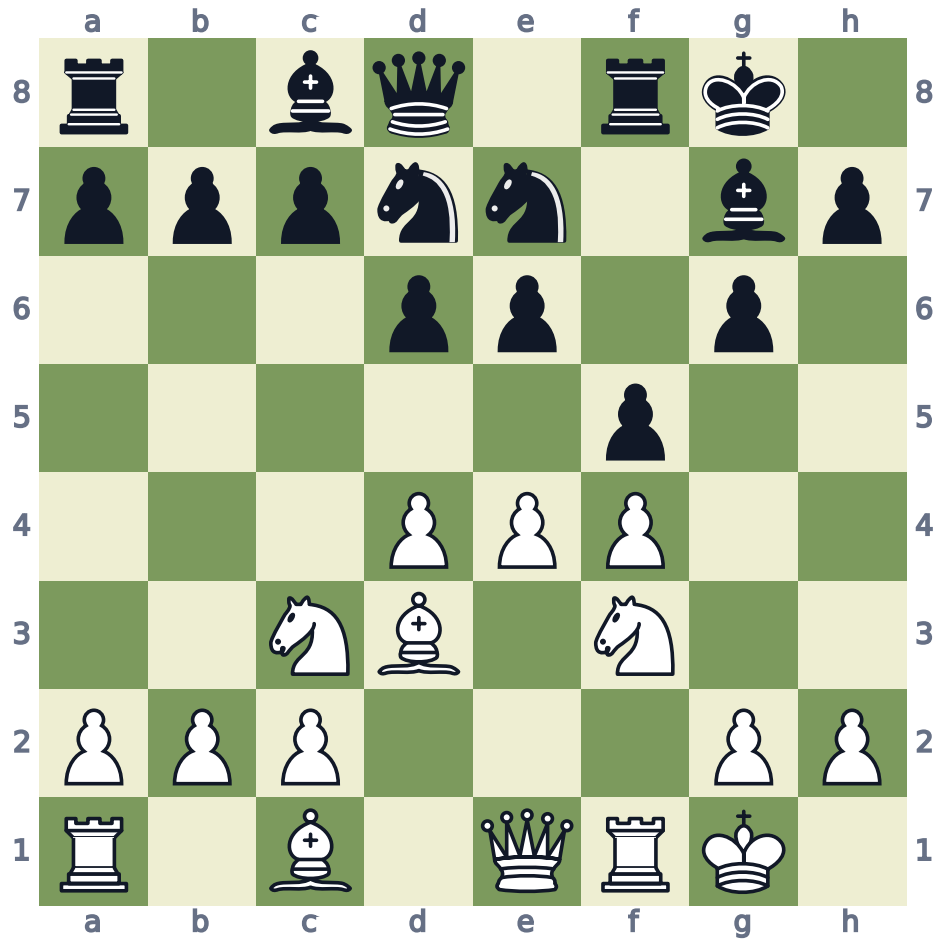
White to move. Identify the setup and move-order clue. Choose the course move. Explain the purpose, the opponent's best practical reply, the likely pawn structure, and the tactical feature that must be checked before moving.

TEN-POINT SCORE

2 identification | 2 move | 2 purpose | 2 reply | 1 structure | 1 tactical check

MIXED TEST 55 OF 60

Identify, choose, explain



YOUR COMPLETE ANSWER

White to move. Identify the setup and move-order clue. Choose the course move. Explain the purpose, the opponent's best practical reply, the likely pawn structure, and the tactical feature that must be checked before moving.

TEN-POINT SCORE

2 identification | 2 move | 2 purpose | 2 reply | 1 structure | 1 tactical check

MIXED TEST 56 OF 60

Identify, choose, explain



YOUR COMPLETE ANSWER

Black to move. Identify the setup and move-order clue. Choose the course move. Explain the purpose, the opponent's best practical reply, the likely pawn structure, and the tactical feature that must be checked before moving.

TEN-POINT SCORE

2 identification | 2 move | 2 purpose | 2 reply | 1 structure | 1 tactical check

MIXED TEST 57 OF 60

Identify, choose, explain



YOUR COMPLETE ANSWER

Black to move. Identify the setup and move-order clue. Choose the course move. Explain the purpose, the opponent's best practical reply, the likely pawn structure, and the tactical feature that must be checked before moving.

TEN-POINT SCORE

2 identification | 2 move | 2 purpose | 2 reply | 1 structure | 1 tactical check

Identify, choose, explain

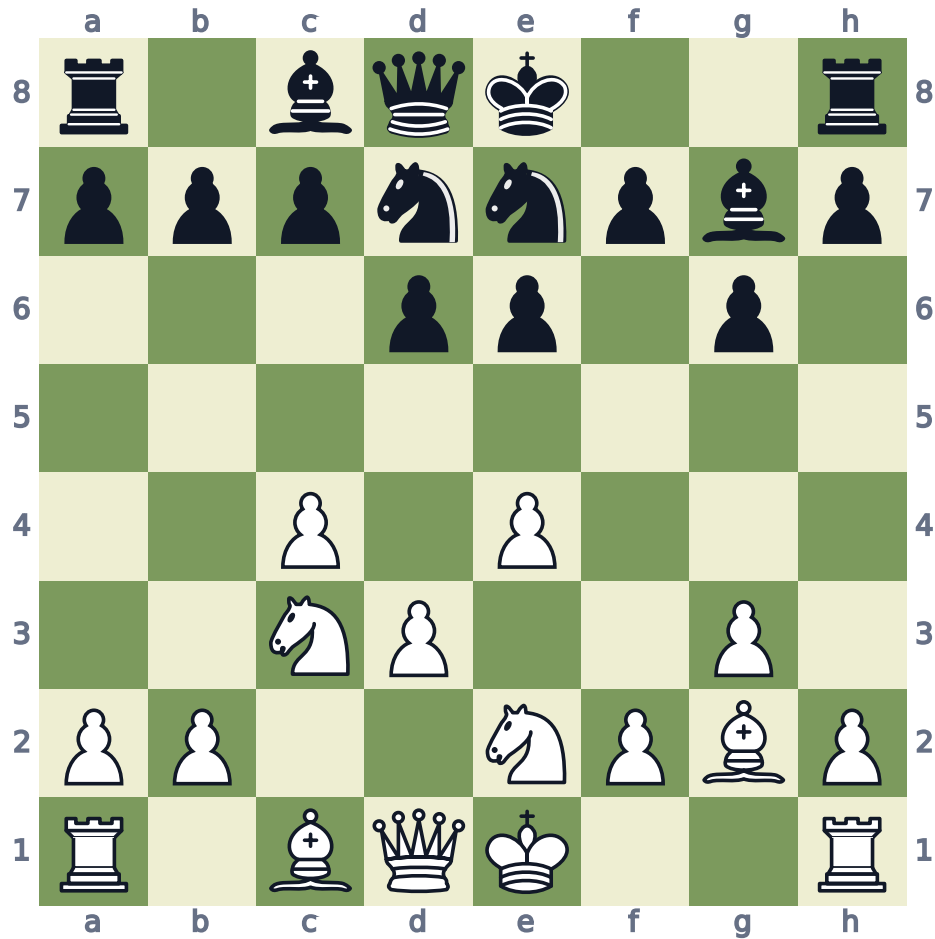


TEN-POINT SCORE

63

MIXED TEST 59 OF 60

Identify, choose, explain



YOUR COMPLETE ANSWER

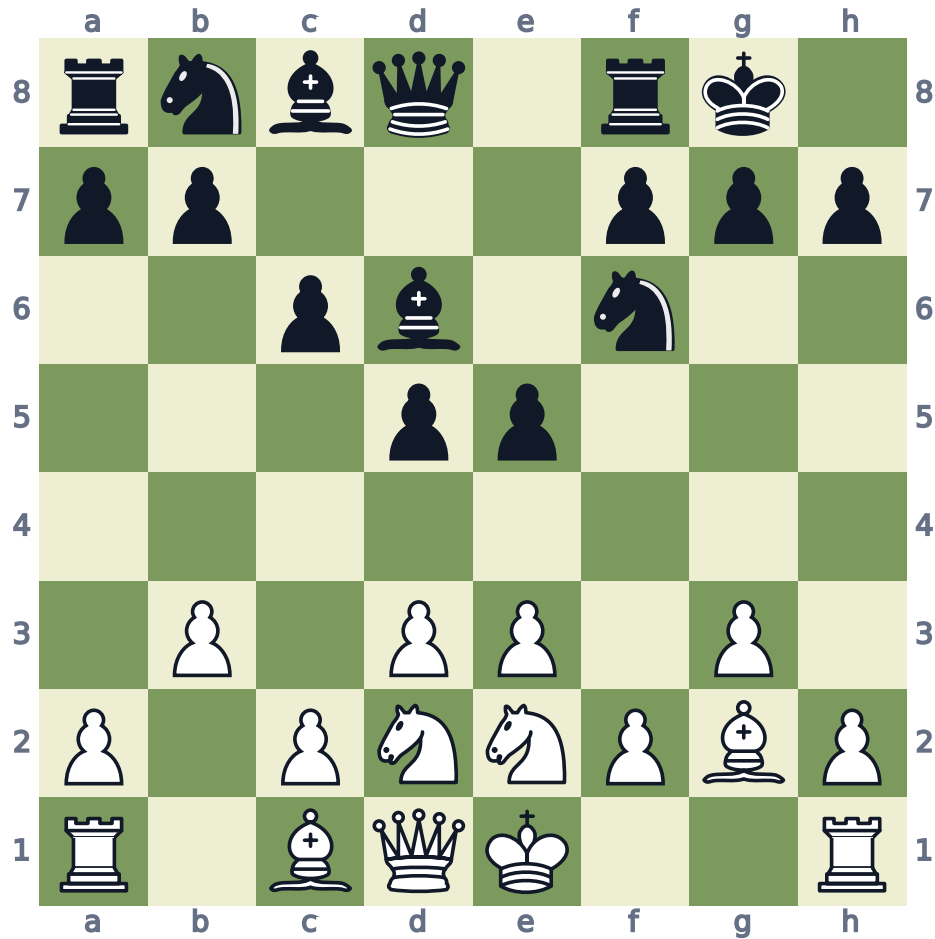
Black to move. Identify the setup and move-order clue. Choose the course move. Explain the purpose, the opponent's best practical reply, the likely pawn structure, and the tactical feature that must be checked before moving.

TEN-POINT SCORE

2 identification | 2 move | 2 purpose | 2 reply | 1 structure | 1 tactical check

MIXED TEST 60 OF 60

Identify, choose, explain



YOUR COMPLETE ANSWER

Black to move. Identify the setup and move-order clue. Choose the course move. Explain the purpose, the opponent's best practical reply, the likely pawn structure, and the tactical feature that must be checked before moving.

TEN-POINT SCORE

2 identification | 2 move | 2 purpose | 2 reply | 1 structure | 1 tactical check

ANSWER SECTION

Final-exam solutions

USE ERRORS DIAGNOSTICALLY

A wrong move is only the surface. Decide whether the cause was opening identification, move-order memory, tactical blindness, misunderstanding of the plan, or rushed calculation. Repair the cause with one exact question.

SOLUTIONS

Tests 1-3

01. POLISH OPENING

Source: Hippo vs English, Reti, and Flank Openings. Course answer: Bg7. Purpose: Develop, attack the advanced b-pawn later, and keep central options open. Transfer question: What move-order clue should trigger this answer next time?

02. KING STAYS FLEXIBLE UNDER H-PAWN PRESSURE

Source: Hippo Model Games and Guess-the-Move Training. Course answer: Nce2. Purpose: Avoid short castling into an attack and prepare queenside space. Transfer question: What move-order clue should trigger this answer next time?

03. REROUTE THE E7 KNIGHT

Source: Hippo Model Games and Guess-the-Move Training. Course answer: dxe5. Purpose: Use h6 to ask the bishop a question and prepare a knight route to f5 or g6. Transfer question: What move-order clue should trigger this answer next time?

SOLUTIONS

Tests 4-6

04. WHITE HIPPO VS DELAYED QUEENSIDE FIANCHETTO

Source: White Hippopotamus Companion. Course answer: Nd2. Purpose: Use the move-order information to prepare c4 or e4 before Black completes development. Transfer question: What move-order clue should trigger this answer next time?

05. ROOK BEHIND THE E-PAWN

Source: Hippo Piece Maneuvers and Defensive Architecture. Course answer: Ne7. Purpose: Put a rook behind the central contact point and increase the force of e5 ideas. Transfer question: What move-order clue should trigger this answer next time?

06. C5 AGAINST THE CLASSICAL E4 CENTER

Source: Hippo Pawn-Structure and Plan Atlas. Course answer: dxc5. Purpose: Pressure d4 and invite a structure Black can attack on the c-file. Transfer question: What move-order clue should trigger this answer next time?

SOLUTIONS

Tests 7-9

07. COLLE SYSTEM

Source: Hippo Pawn-Structure and Plan Atlas. Course answer: Re1. Purpose: Use White's modest setup to complete development before central contact. Transfer question: What move-order clue should trigger this answer next time?

08. COLLE SYSTEM

Source: Hippo vs 1.d4: Queen's Pawn Centers. Course answer: e6. Purpose: Use White's modest setup to complete development before central contact. Transfer question: What move-order clue should trigger this answer next time?

09. E5 AGAINST THE AUSTRIAN CENTER

Source: Hippo Pawn-Structure and Plan Atlas. Course answer: fxe5. Purpose: Hit d4 before White advances e5 and f5. Transfer question: What move-order clue should trigger this answer next time?

SOLUTIONS

Tests 10-12

10. E5 AGAINST THE BOTVINNIK ENGLISH

Source: The Hippo e5 Break. Course answer: e6. Purpose: Fix d4, restrain White's center, and prepare f5.

Transfer question: What move-order clue should trigger this answer next time?

11. C5 AFTER BE2

Source: The Hippo c5 Break. Course answer: e6. Purpose: Use the safe king as permission to challenge the center immediately. Transfer question: What move-order clue should trigger this answer next time?

12. AUSTRIAN-STYLE CENTER MAP

Source: Hippo Foundations and Setup Map. Course answer: e6. Purpose: Restrain the center and prepare a challenge to e4 or d4. Transfer question: What move-order clue should trigger this answer next time?

SOLUTIONS

Tests 13-15

13. B5 BREAK COMPASS

Source: Hippo Foundations and Setup Map. Course answer: Ne7. Purpose: Gain queenside space and prepare b4 against a stable center. Transfer question: What move-order clue should trigger this answer next time?

14. WHITE ADVANCES E5 EARLY

Source: Hippo vs 1.e4: Classical Centers. Course answer: dxe5. Purpose: Eliminate the advanced pawn or pressure it before completing the Hippo shell. Transfer question: What move-order clue should trigger this answer next time?

15. WHITE HIPPO VS IMMEDIATE D5-E5

Source: White Hippopotamus Companion. Course answer: Nd2. Purpose: Build toward Bb2 and e4, using the extra tempo to challenge Black's center. Transfer question: What move-order clue should trigger this answer next time?

SOLUTIONS

Tests 16-18

16. EARLY F4 CHANGES THE ORDER

Source: Hippo Move Orders, Transpositions, and Early Deviations. Course answer: d6. Purpose: Secure the king and prepare f5 or e5 before slower queenside moves. Transfer question: What move-order clue should trigger this answer next time?

17. LARSEN OPENING

Source: Hippo vs English, Reti, and Flank Openings. Course answer: Bg7. Purpose: Occupy the center only after development clarifies White's plan. Transfer question: What move-order clue should trigger this answer next time?

18. C5 IN A DOUBLE-FIANCHETTO POSITION

Source: Hippo Pawn-Structure and Plan Atlas. Course answer: Ne4. Purpose: Challenge d4 while both bishops point toward the center. Transfer question: What move-order clue should trigger this answer next time?

SOLUTIONS

Tests 19-21

19. TORRE BISHOP ON G5

Source: Hippo vs 1.d4: Queen's Pawn Centers. Course answer: d6. Purpose: Build the shell while asking whether the bishop's pin has any concrete force. Transfer question: What move-order clue should trigger this answer next time?

20. WHITE HIPPO VS SICILIAN SETUP

Source: White Hippopotamus Companion. Course answer: e3. Purpose: Use c3 to close the long diagonal, then choose e4 or d4 to contest the center. Transfer question: What move-order clue should trigger this answer next time?

21. HOLD THE QUEEN UNTIL THE CENTER SETTLES

Source: Hippo Move Orders, Transpositions, and Early Deviations. Course answer: d6. Purpose: Keep Qe8, Qd7, and c7 available until the break and king location are known. Transfer question: What move-order clue should trigger this answer next time?

SOLUTIONS

Tests 22-24

22. F5 AGAINST THE AUSTRIAN CENTER

Source: Hippo Pawn-Structure and Plan Atlas. Course answer: e5. Purpose: Attack e4 and contest the kingside before White plays f5. Transfer question: What move-order clue should trigger this answer next time?

23. WHITE HIPPO AND E4 PREPARATION

Source: White Hippopotamus Companion. Course answer: Nd2. Purpose: Finish the shell only long enough to make e4 safe and effective. Transfer question: What move-order clue should trigger this answer next time?

24. RETI WITH E4

Source: Hippo Pawn-Structure and Plan Atlas. Course answer: a4. Purpose: Maintain flexibility until e4 identifies a familiar Hippo center. Transfer question: What move-order clue should trigger this answer next time?

SOLUTIONS

Tests 25-27

25. ENGLISH FIANCHETTO

Source: Hippo Pawn-Structure and Plan Atlas. Course answer: a6. Purpose: Transpose to a Hippo after White occupies e4 and prepare c5 or e5. Transfer question: What move-order clue should trigger this answer next time?

26. F5 IN THE REVERSED AUSTRIAN

Source: The Hippo f5 and b5 Breaks. Course answer: e6. Purpose: Use symmetrical contact to exploit White's exposed e4 pawn. Transfer question: What move-order clue should trigger this answer next time?

27. C5 AGAINST THE BROAD D4 CENTER

Source: Hippo Pawn-Structure and Plan Atlas. Course answer: Nb5. Purpose: Attack d4 and open a queenside route for the rook and queen. Transfer question: What move-order clue should trigger this answer next time?

SOLUTIONS

Tests 28-30

28. WHITE HIPPO VS OWEN-STYLE B6

Source: White Hippopotamus Companion. Course answer: Nd2. Purpose: Use Black's d5 commitment to complete the shell and prepare e4 or c4. Transfer question: What move-order clue should trigger this answer next time?

29. WHITE MIRRORED HIPPO

Source: White Hippopotamus Companion. Course answer: Nd2. Purpose: Use the extra tempo to claim a useful central break first. Transfer question: What move-order clue should trigger this answer next time?

30. WHITE HIPPO VS SICILIAN SETUP

Source: Hippo Pawn-Structure and Plan Atlas. Course answer: O-O. Purpose: Use c3 to close the long diagonal, then choose e4 or d4 to contest the center. Transfer question: What move-order clue should trigger this answer next time?

SOLUTIONS

Tests 31-33

31. CORE SHELL AGAINST E4 AND D4

Source: Hippo Foundations and Setup Map. Course answer: e6. Purpose: Complete the compact shell while keeping all four breaks available. Transfer question: What move-order clue should trigger this answer next time?

32. 150 ATTACK STYLE DEVELOPMENT

Source: Hippo vs 1.e4: Classical Centers. Course answer: e6. Purpose: Delay castling, develop the queenside bishop, and create counterplay against the long-castled king. Transfer question: What move-order clue should trigger this answer next time?

33. LONDON SYSTEM

Source: Hippo vs 1.d4: Queen's Pawn Centers. Course answer: e6. Purpose: Develop without chasing Bf4 and prepare e5 or c5 against d4. Transfer question: What move-order clue should trigger this answer next time?

SOLUTIONS

Tests 34-36

34. EARLY H-PAWN MAP

Source: Hippo Foundations and Setup Map. Course answer: h6. Purpose: Slow the h-pawn, keep the king flexible, and seek queenside counterplay. Transfer question: What move-order clue should trigger this answer next time?

35. E5 AGAINST A ROOK ON E1

Source: Hippo Pawn-Structure and Plan Atlas. Course answer: dxe5. Purpose: Challenge d4 while using piece support to survive e-file tactics. Transfer question: What move-order clue should trigger this answer next time?

36. CLOSE THE H-FILE ATTACK CAREFULLY

Source: Hippo Pawn-Structure and Plan Atlas. Course answer: fxg5. Purpose: Block immediate hxg6 ideas and prepare a central counterbreak. Transfer question: What move-order clue should trigger this answer next time?

SOLUTIONS

Tests 37-39

37. BIRD CENTER MAP

Source: Hippo Foundations and Setup Map. Course answer: d6. Purpose: Treat the position as a reversed Austrian center and target e4. Transfer question: What move-order clue should trigger this answer next time?

38. 1...D6 FIRST AGAINST E4

Source: Hippo Model Games and Guess-the-Move Training. Course answer: a4. Purpose: Use d6 to discourage some early e5 tactics, then transpose into the shell. Transfer question: What move-order clue should trigger this answer next time?

39. LONG CASTLE WITH H5

Source: Hippo vs 1.e4: Classical Centers. Course answer: e6. Purpose: Develop Bb7 and prepare queenside play without ignoring the h-file. Transfer question: What move-order clue should trigger this answer next time?

SOLUTIONS

Tests 40-42

40. WHITE HIPPO VS QUEEN'S INDIAN SHELL

Source: White Hippopotamus Companion. Course answer: Nd2. Purpose: Develop harmoniously and use c4 or e4 before Black owns the center. Transfer question: What move-order clue should trigger this answer next time?

41. FOUR-PAWN EXPANSION

Source: Hippo vs 1.e4: Classical Centers. Course answer: d6. Purpose: Strike the center while White spends tempi expanding on the wing. Transfer question: What move-order clue should trigger this answer next time?

42. REROUTE THE E7 KNIGHT

Source: Hippo Pawn-Structure and Plan Atlas. Course answer: Bb7. Purpose: Use h6 to ask the bishop a question and prepare a knight route to f5 or g6. Transfer question: What move-order clue should trigger this answer next time?

SOLUTIONS

Tests 43-45

43. JOBAVA-STYLE NC3 AND BF4

Source: Hippo vs 1.d4: Queen's Pawn Centers. Course answer: d6. Purpose: Keep the king flexible and seek c5 against White's queenside castling plan. Transfer question: What move-order clue should trigger this answer next time?

44. ROOK BEHIND THE E-PAWN

Source: Hippo Pawn-Structure and Plan Atlas. Course answer: c5. Purpose: Put a rook behind the central contact point and increase the force of e5 ideas. Transfer question: What move-order clue should trigger this answer next time?

45. CLASSICAL QUEEN'S PAWN CENTER

Source: Hippo Pawn-Structure and Plan Atlas. Course answer: Rad1. Purpose: Complete the shell and prepare c5 or e5 against the broad center. Transfer question: What move-order clue should trigger this answer next time?

SOLUTIONS

Tests 46-48

46. WHITE CLOSES WITH D5

Source: Hippo vs 1.e4: Classical Centers. Course answer: e6. Purpose: Challenge the closed chain before White consolidates a space advantage. Transfer question: What move-order clue should trigger this answer next time?

47. CLASSICAL D4-C4-E4 SHELL

Source: Hippo Foundations and Setup Map. Course answer: e6. Purpose: Build against the broad center and compare e5 with c5. Transfer question: What move-order clue should trigger this answer next time?

48. E5 AGAINST THE CLASSICAL D4 CENTER

Source: Hippo Model Games and Guess-the-Move Training. Course answer: Qd2. Purpose: Attack d4, free the queen and knights, and force White to define the center. Transfer question: What move-order clue should trigger this answer next time?

SOLUTIONS

Tests 49-51

49. F5 AGAINST LONG-CASTLE PREPARATION

Source: Hippo Pawn-Structure and Plan Atlas. Course answer: h4. Purpose: Challenge e4 while White's king is headed away from the f-file. Transfer question: What move-order clue should trigger this answer next time?

50. F5 AGAINST THE AUSTRIAN CENTER

Source: Hippo Model Games and Guess-the-Move Training. Course answer: Bb5. Purpose: Attack e4 and contest the kingside before White plays f5. Transfer question: What move-order clue should trigger this answer next time?

51. WHITE HIPPO VS FRENCH SHELL

Source: White Hippopotamus Companion. Course answer: Nd2. Purpose: Use e4 or c4 to prevent a free central occupation. Transfer question: What move-order clue should trigger this answer next time?

SOLUTIONS

Tests 52-54

52. 1.NC3 TRANSPOSITION

Source: Hippo vs English, Reti, and Flank Openings. Course answer: d6. Purpose: Recognize the 150 Attack structure and keep the king flexible. Transfer question: What move-order clue should trigger this answer next time?

53. DELAY D6 UNTIL THE CENTER APPEARS

Source: Hippo Pawn-Structure and Plan Atlas. Course answer: Bh6. Purpose: Preserve transpositions, then choose d6 once White shows e4-d4. Transfer question: What move-order clue should trigger this answer next time?

54. CLOSE THE H-FILE ATTACK CAREFULLY

Source: Hippo Model Games and Guess-the-Move Training. Course answer: g5. Purpose: Block immediate hxg6 ideas and prepare a central counterbreak. Transfer question: What move-order clue should trigger this answer next time?

SOLUTIONS

Tests 55-57

55. AUSTRIAN CENTER AND F5 COUNTERSTRIKE

Source: Hippo Pawn-Structure and Plan Atlas. Course answer: h3. Purpose: Challenge e4 before White's e5-f5 expansion takes over the kingside. Transfer question: What move-order clue should trigger this answer next time?

56. FIANCHETTO CENTER MAP

Source: Hippo Foundations and Setup Map. Course answer: e6. Purpose: Keep a compact position while preparing Bb7 and central contact. Transfer question: What move-order clue should trigger this answer next time?

57. CATALAN FIANCHETTO

Source: Hippo vs 1.d4: Queen's Pawn Centers. Course answer: e6. Purpose: Prepare Bb7 and central contact while respecting the long diagonal. Transfer question: What move-order clue should trigger this answer next time?

SOLUTIONS

Tests 58-60

58. CLASSICAL CENTER WITH NF3 AND BD3

Source: Hippo Pawn-Structure and Plan Atlas. Course answer: Rad1. Purpose: Finish development while preparing the break that attacks White's less-supported center pawn. Transfer question: What move-order clue should trigger this answer next time?

59. BOTVNNIK ENGLISH SETUP

Source: Hippo Pawn-Structure and Plan Atlas. Course answer: a6. Purpose: Restrict d4, develop compactly, and aim for f5 or c5. Transfer question: What move-order clue should trigger this answer next time?

60. WHITE HIPPO VS E5-D5

Source: Hippo Pawn-Structure and Plan Atlas. Course answer: a5. Purpose: Prepare Bb2 and choose e4 or c4 based on Black's support. Transfer question: What move-order clue should trigger this answer next time?

STUDY PLAN

A sixty-day route through the course

DAYS 1-10

Learn Volume 1 and the first half of Volume 2. Build the shell from memory and name White's urgent break.

DAYS 11-20

Finish Volumes 2-5. Mix e4, d4, and flank openings so the first move cannot reveal the answer.

DAYS 21-30

Study Volumes 6-8. Compare e5, c5, f5, and b5 in every position before revealing the course choice.

DAYS 31-40

Study Volumes 9-11. Practice piece routes, emergency defenses, and the White Hippo companion.

DAYS 41-50

Study Volumes 12-14. Classify structures, solve tactics, and predict every model-game decision.

DAYS 51-60

Take Volume 15's mixed exam, repair misses, and play training games from the supplied PGN positions.

FRITZ COMPANION

Turn files into active training

1. IMPORT REPERTOIRE PGN

Open the supplied Black_Hippopotamus_Repertoire.pgn and replay each branch from both sides.

2. LOAD TRAINING POSITIONS

Use Training_Positions.pgn or the FEN column in Training_Positions.csv to start from a recall diagram.

3. PLAY THE POSITION

Play against a restrained strength first; raise it only when you can explain the plan during the game.

4. ANALYZE AFTERWARD

Record your candidates and evaluation before turning on analysis. Compare the first divergence, not only the final blunder.

5. CREATE A PERSONAL BRANCH

Add the move that occurred in your own game and one reliable response. Keep the comment in plain language.

6. SCHEDULE THE MISS

Review the position tomorrow, in three days, one week, two weeks, one month, and two months.

VOLUME REVIEW

Make the repertoire usable

REVIEW TASK 1

Reconstruct every branch from the first move without looking.

REVIEW TASK 2

For each branch, explain one Black plan and one White plan.

REVIEW TASK 3

Shuffle the recall positions so the chapter title cannot reveal the answer.

REVIEW TASK 4

Play each starting position against Fritz from both sides.

REVIEW TASK 5

Add mistakes from your own games to the PGN as new training positions.

REVIEW TASK 6

Retest the weakest three branches after 1, 3, 7, 14, 30, and 60 days.

GRADUATION STANDARD

Score at least 80 percent twice, one week apart, and explain every move in plain language. Then maintain the volume through your own games instead of rereading it continuously.